SAMU - Rwanda Biomedical Centre

SAMU Roster

User manual

For the Administrator

About this manual

This manual explains everything the administrator does in SAMU Roster, screen by screen: setting up the system, building the roster, reviewing and publishing it, and handling changes afterwards.

In this manual

1. Your role
2. Signing in and getting around
3. Setting up (do this once, then keep it current)
4. Generating the roster
5. How a roster moves from draft to published
6. Checking and submitting a roster
7. Changes after the roster exists
8. Reading the roster board
9. If something goes wrong

Version 1 - 24 October 2026 - This manual covers only what this role does.

Your role

As **administrator** you set up everything the roster depends on, build the whole roster, review it and publish it. You are the only role that can create accounts, edit staff, stations and leave, and publish.

> **TIP** The screenshots in this manual use **fictional demo data**. The names, numbers and dates on your system will differ, but the screens and buttons are the same. The orange numbers on a picture match the numbered list under it.

You can	You cannot
Set up stations, ambulances, facilities, employees, leave and users	Change a published roster by regenerating it
Generate drivers, medical crew and dispatch together, or any part	Reopen a published roster (only a submitted one)
Check conflicts, submit, reopen, publish and delete rosters	Remove or demote the last active administrator
Replace crew members, set crew leaders, accept a short crew	
Create events, review command decisions, read the activity log	

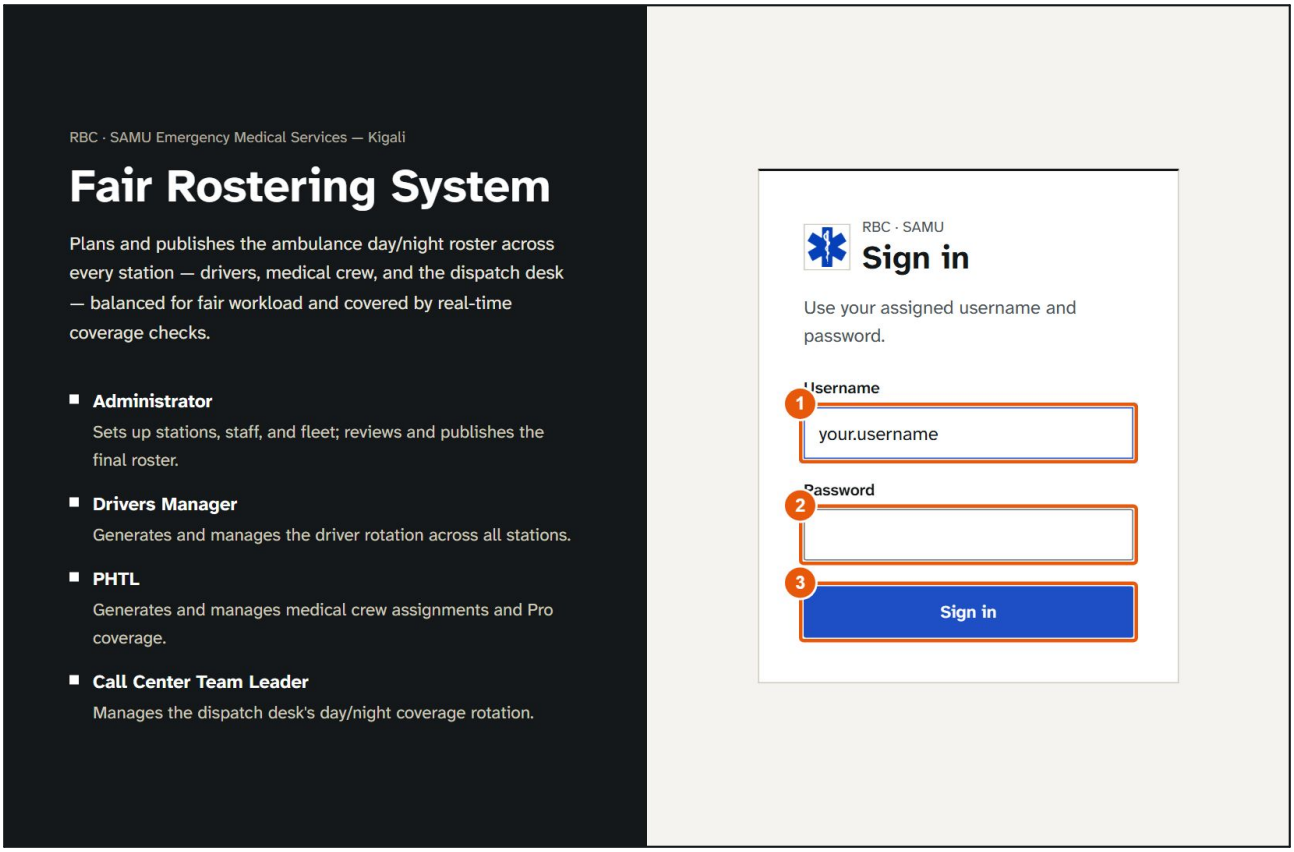
Menu group	Pages
Overview	Dashboard
Setup	Stations, Ambulances, Facilities
Workforce	Employees, Leave, Users
Planning	Generate Roster
Roster Board	Roster Board
Crew Operations	Crew Rollup, Mark Unavailable
Events	Events
Admin	Notifications, Activity Log, Command Decisions

Signing in and getting around

1. Open **https://ems-rw.duckdns.org** in a browser on a computer or phone.
2. Type your **username** and **password** exactly as given to you. The username is case sensitive and can contain a space.
3. Press **Sign in**.

The sign-in page

Open the SAMU Roster address in a browser on a computer or phone.



1	Type your username exactly as given to you (capital letters and spaces matter).
2	Type your password.
3	Press Sign in.

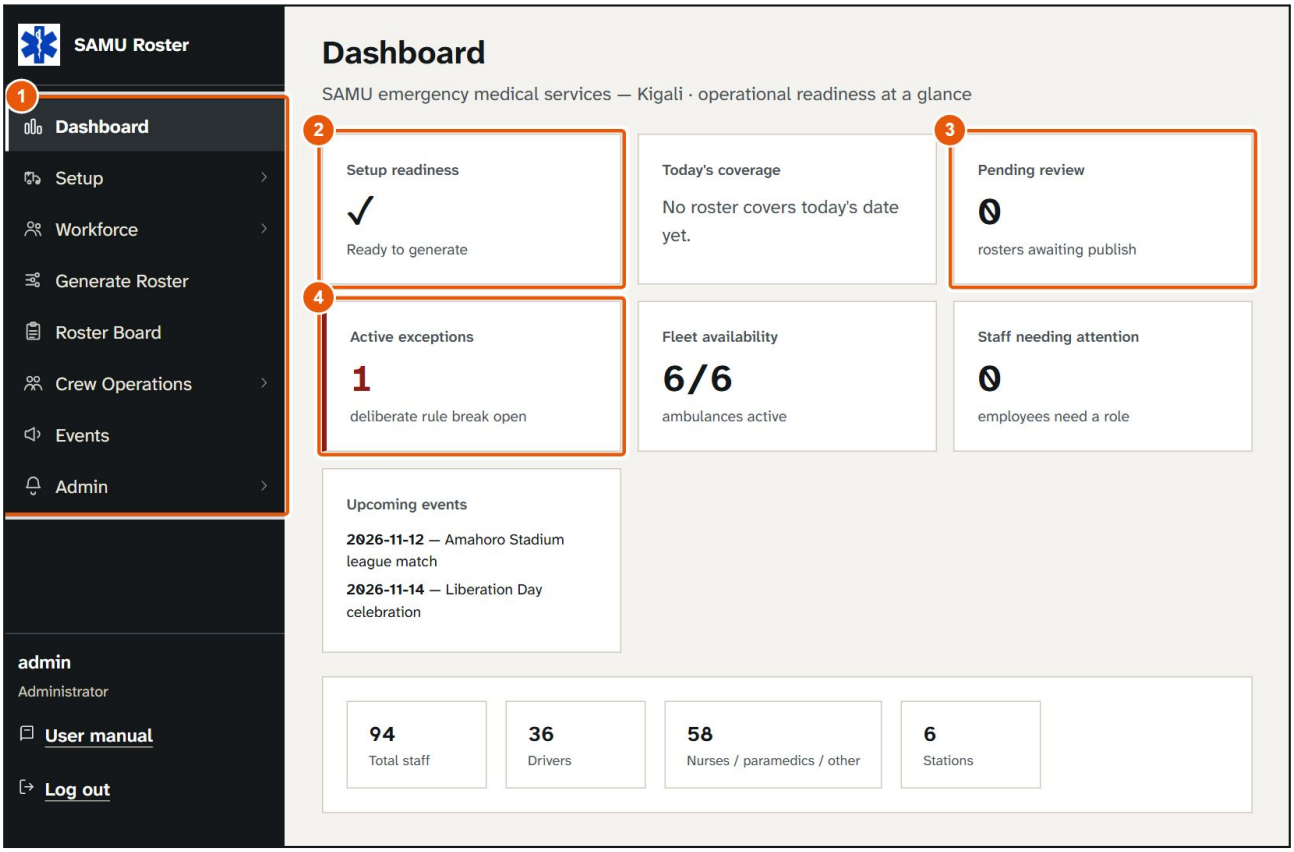
> **IMPORTANT** After **5 wrong passwords** for the same username, sign-in is blocked for 15 minutes. You stay signed in for 12 hours, then you sign in again. There is no way to change your own password in the app: ask the administrator to set a new one.

The Dashboard and your menu

After signing in you land on the Dashboard. The menu on the left lists only the pages your role can open.

The Dashboard

Your first page after signing in. The menu on the left lists only the pages your role can open.



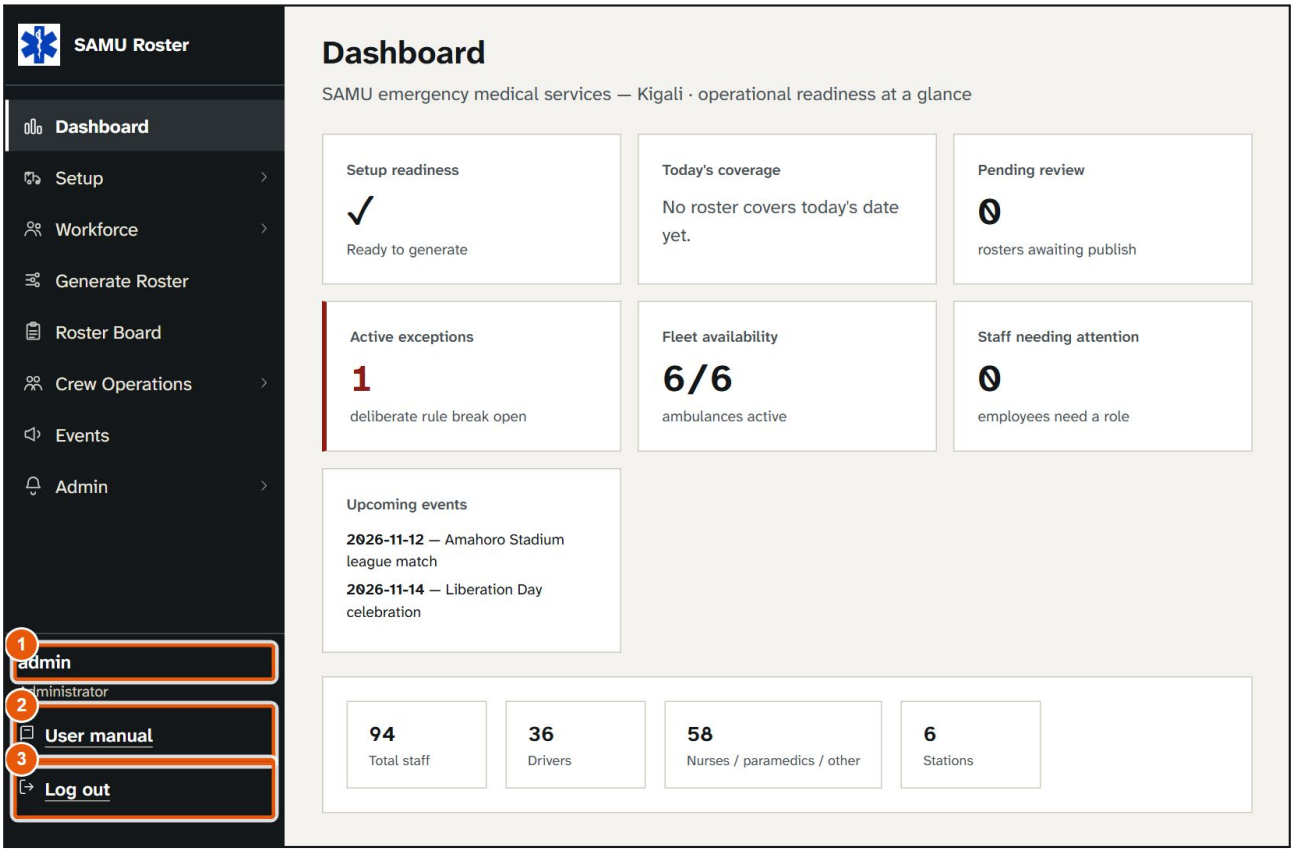
1	The menu: every page you can open. Groups with an arrow open when you click them.
2	Setup readiness: what is still missing before a roster can be built well.
3	Pending review: rosters waiting to be published.
4	Active exceptions: rule breaks approved by managers that still need attention.

This manual and signing out

User manual and **Log out** are at the bottom of the menu, below your name. The manual that opens is always the one for your role.

Your name, this manual and signing out

At the bottom of the menu, below your name.



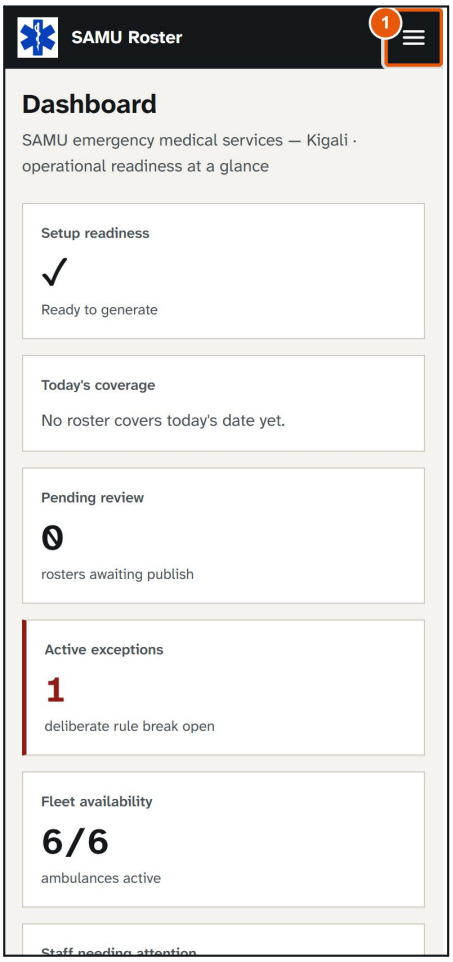
1	Your username and role.
2	User manual: opens this manual, the one written for your role.
3	Log out: ends your session.

On a phone

- Tap the **menu button** (three lines, top right). Groups with an arrow open when you tap them; tap a page and the menu closes.
- Lists appear as cards, one per person or record, with their buttons underneath. The roster grid scrolls sideways: swipe it.

On a phone: the menu button

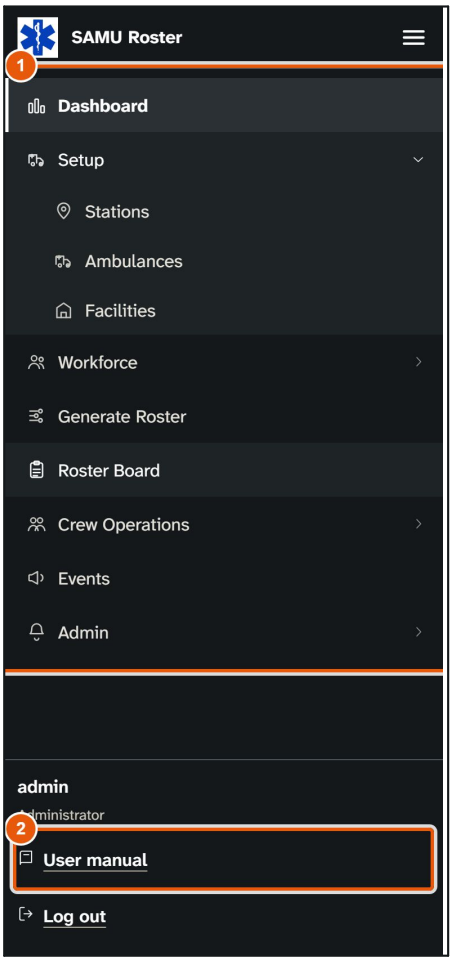
The same page on a phone. The menu is hidden to leave room for the content.



1 Tap the menu button (three lines) at the top right.

On a phone: the open menu

The menu fills the screen. Groups expand where you tap them.



1	Tap a group to expand it, then tap the page you want. The menu closes by itself.
2	User manual and Log out are at the bottom.

Setting up (do this once, then keep it current)

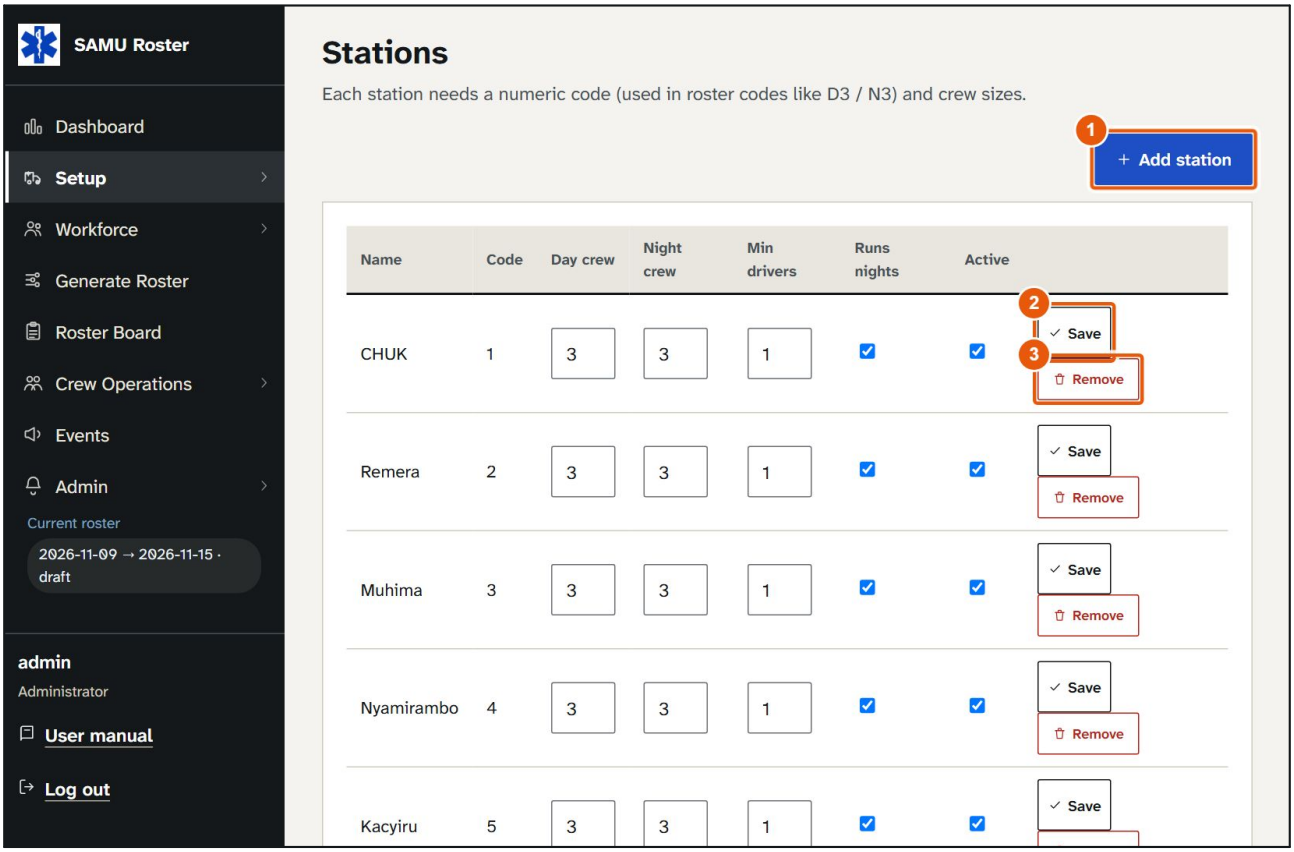
Set up in this order, because each step depends on the one before. The Dashboard card **Setup readiness** and the **Preflight check** on the Generate Roster page tell you what is still missing.

1. Stations

Setup > Stations lists the stations. Each produces its own shift codes: code 3 gives D3 and N3. Press **Add station** and fill the form.

Stations

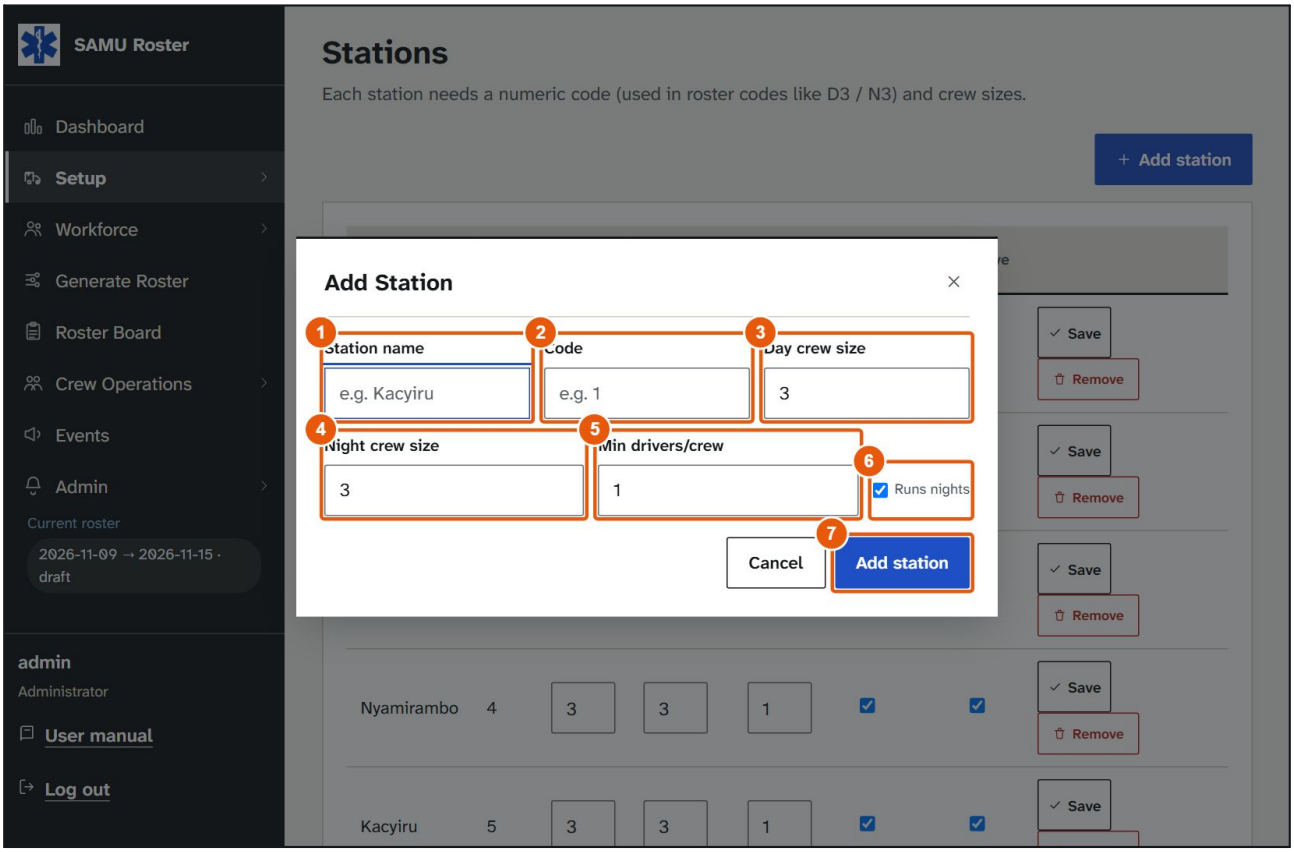
Each station produces its own shift codes (code 3 gives D3 and N3).



1	Add station.
2	Edit a row, then Save.
3	Remove a station only if it never had roster history; otherwise set it inactive.

Add a station

Fill the form and press Save.



1	Station name
2	Code: the number used in shift codes; it must be unique
3	Day crew size
4	Night crew size
5	Min drivers/crew: cannot be larger than the crew size
6	Runs nights: turn off for a day-only station
7	Press Add station.

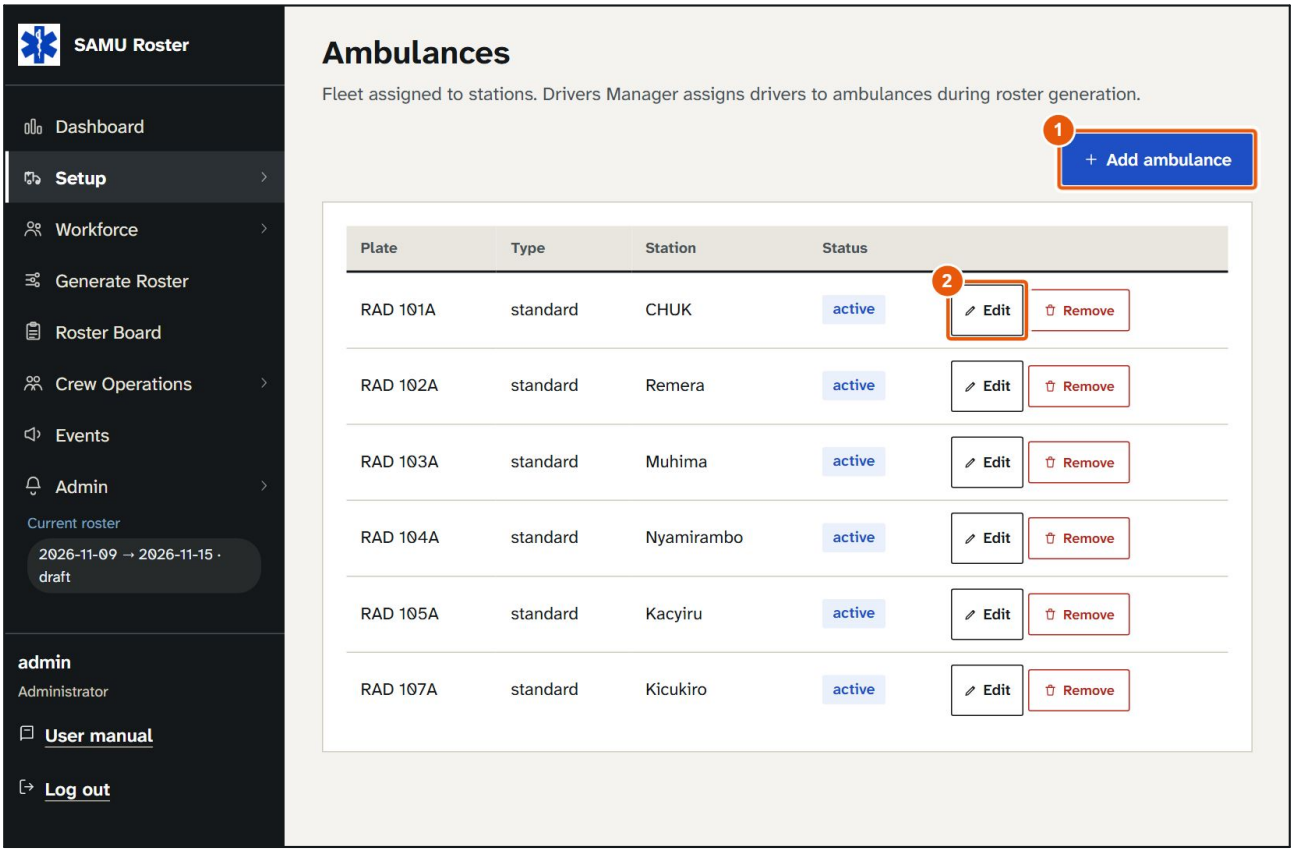
> **TIP** Minimum drivers per crew cannot be larger than the crew size. A station that already has roster history cannot be deleted: set it inactive instead.

2. Ambulances

Setup > Ambulances: add a vehicle with its plate, type, station and status (active, maintenance or out of service). Only active ambulances get crews. A crew placed on an ambulance that is later taken out of service shows up in Check conflicts.

Ambulances

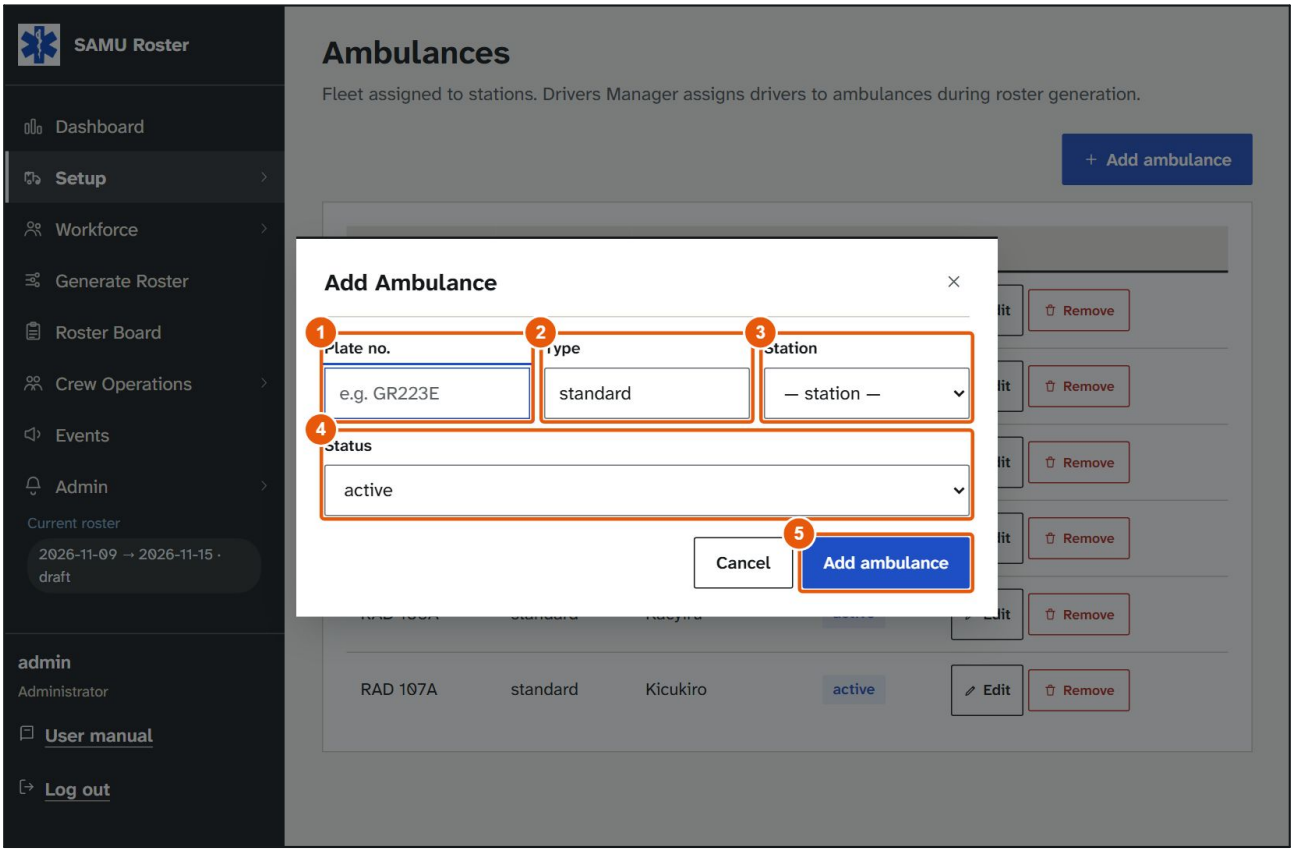
Only active ambulances get crews.



1	Add ambulance.
2	Edit: change the plate, type, station or status (active, maintenance, out of service).

Add an ambulance

Fill the form and press Save.



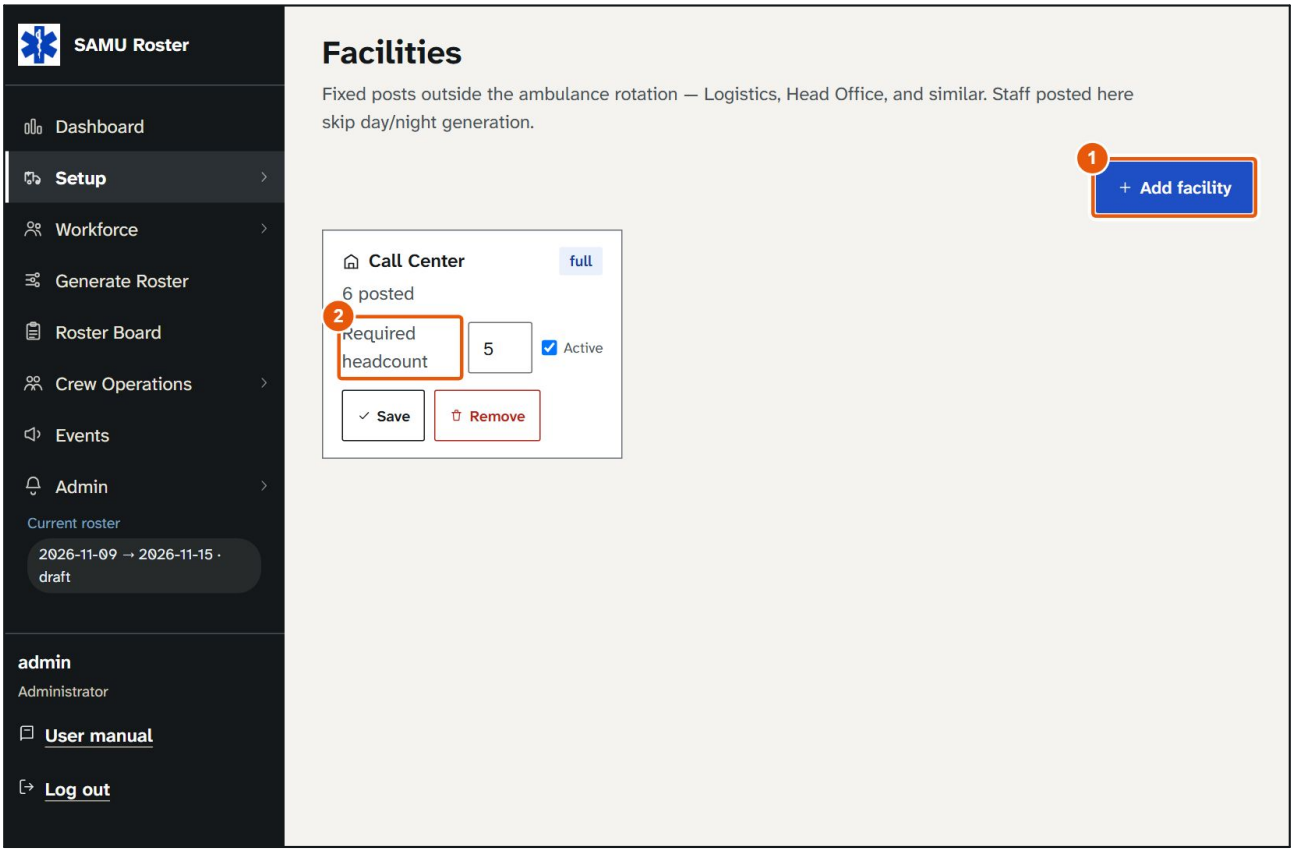
1	Plate no.
2	Type
3	Station
4	Status
5	Press Add ambulance.

3. Facilities (fixed posts)

Setup > Facilities lists non-ambulance posts, for example the call centre. Each has a **Required headcount**. People posted to a facility are a fixed assignment and are not part of the ambulance day and night rotation.

Facilities (fixed posts)

People posted to a facility, such as the call centre, are not part of the ambulance rotation.



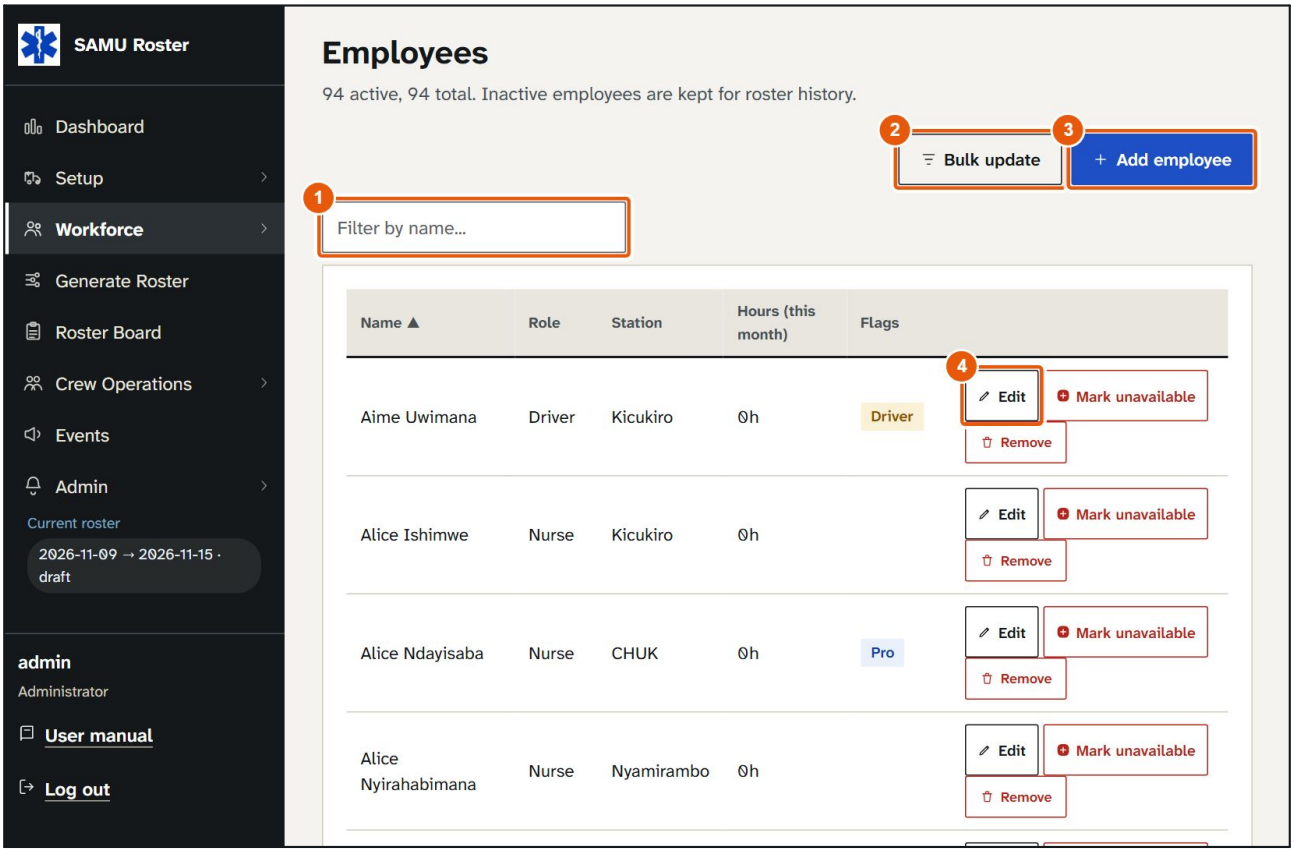
1	Add facility.
2	Required headcount: how many people the post needs on every shift.

4. Employees

Workforce > Employees lists everyone who can appear in a roster. Press **Add employee**, choose a home station *or* a facility posting (never both), and tick what applies.

Employees

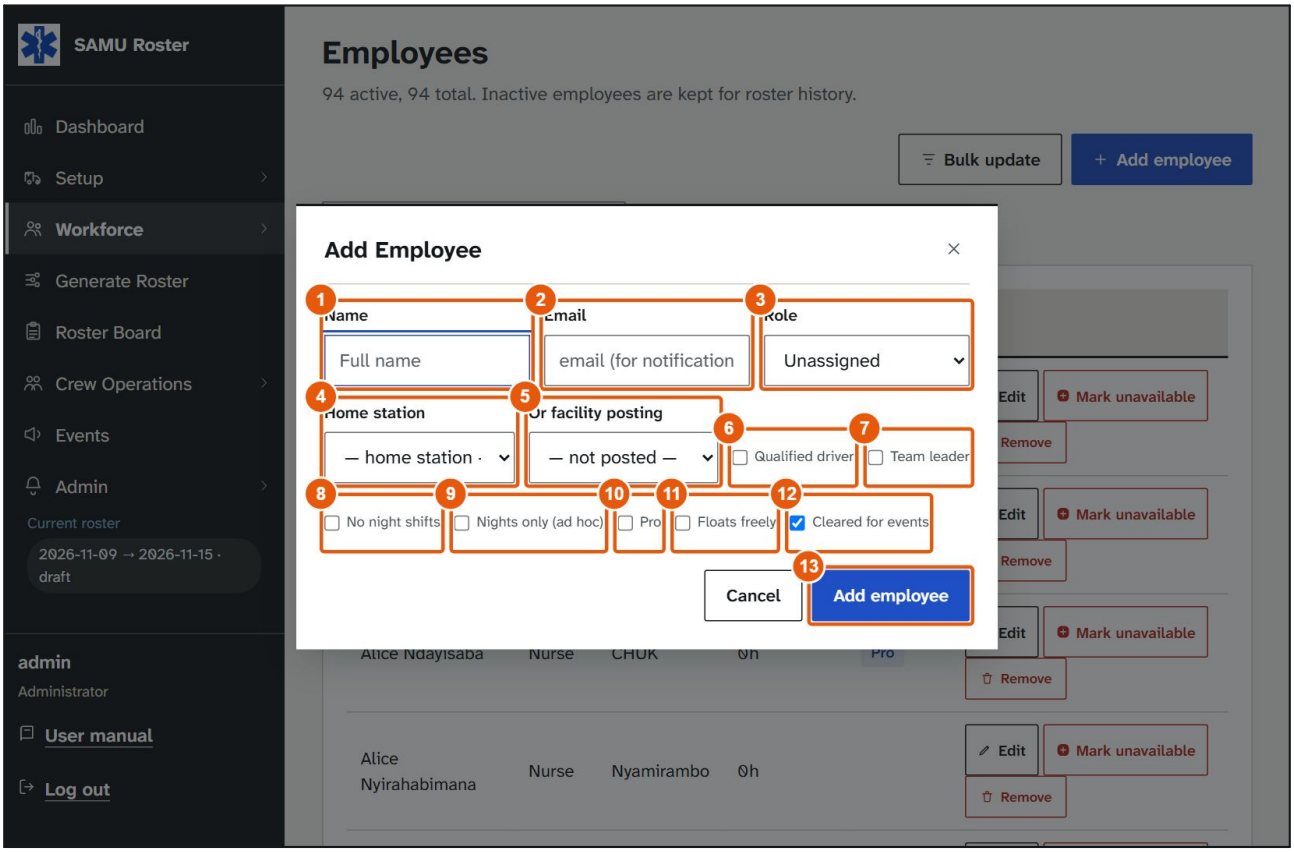
Everyone who can appear in a roster.



1	Filter by name.
2	Bulk update: change a role or flag for many people, with a preview first.
3	Add employee.
4	On each row: Edit, Mark unavailable (opens the Mark Unavailable page for that person) or Remove.

Add an employee

Choose a home station or a facility posting, never both.



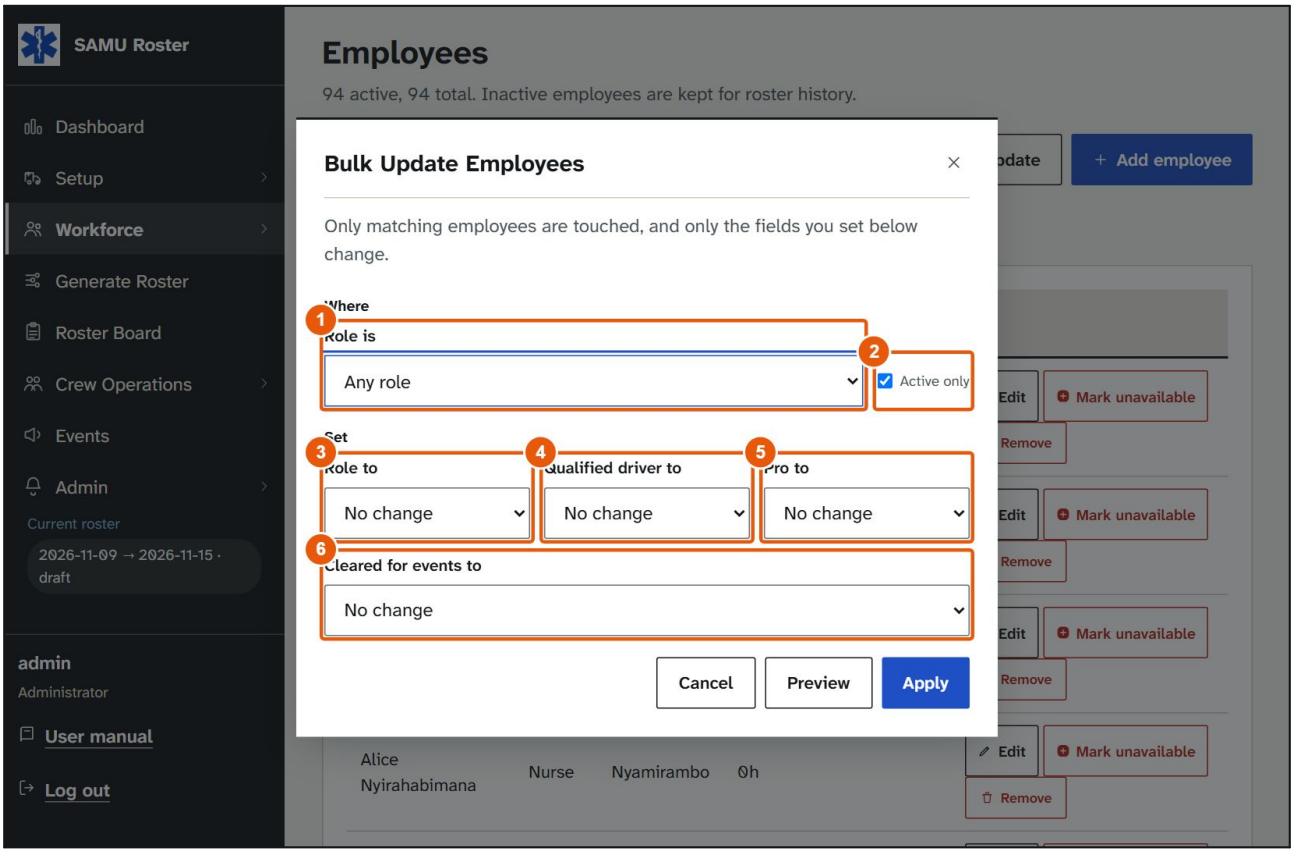
1	Name
2	Email
3	Role
4	Home station
5	Or facility posting
6	Qualified driver: scheduled by the Drivers Manager
7	Team leader
8	No night shifts
9	Nights only (ad hoc): only works nights while ticked
10	Pro: can lead a crew; every crew needs one
11	Floats freely: may work at any station
12	Cleared for events: can be pulled for event duty
13	Press Add employee.

- **Qualified driver**: scheduled by the Drivers Manager. **Pro**: qualified to lead a crew; every crew needs one. **Floats freely**: may work at any station without a home-station preference. **No night shifts**: never given a night. **Nights only (ad hoc)**: only works nights while ticked. **Cleared for events**: can be pulled for event duty.
- New or imported people start with the role *Unassigned*; the Dashboard shows how many **need a role**.
- **Remove** deletes a person only if they were never used in a roster; otherwise the person is deactivated and kept for history.

- **Bulk update** changes a role or flag for many people at once and shows a preview first.

Bulk update

Choose who to change and what to set. A preview shows who would change before anything is saved.



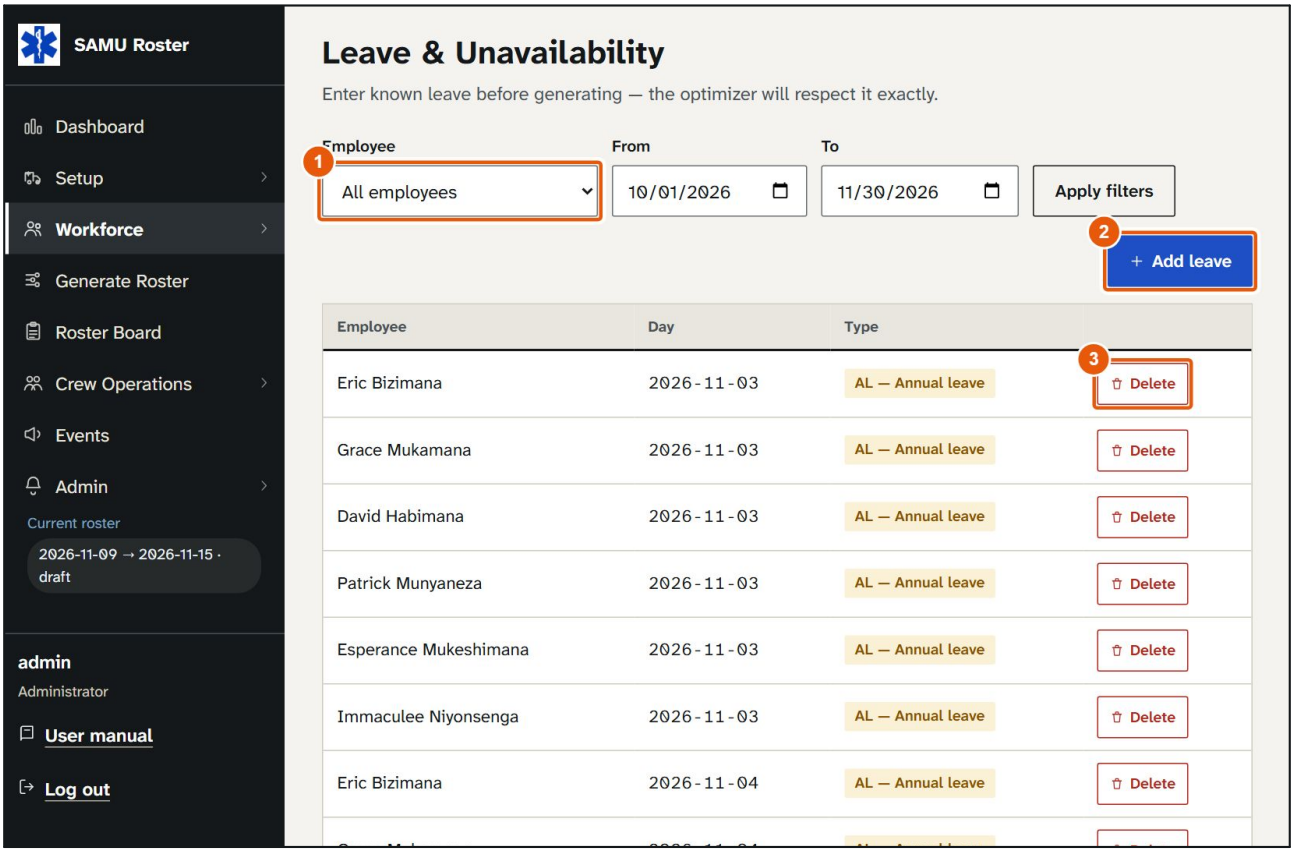
1	Role is
2	Active only
3	Role to
4	Qualified driver to
5	Pro to
6	Cleared for events to

5. Leave

Workforce > Leave: choose the employee, the dates and the type. One record is created for each day. Leave is never overridden by the generator.

Leave and unavailability

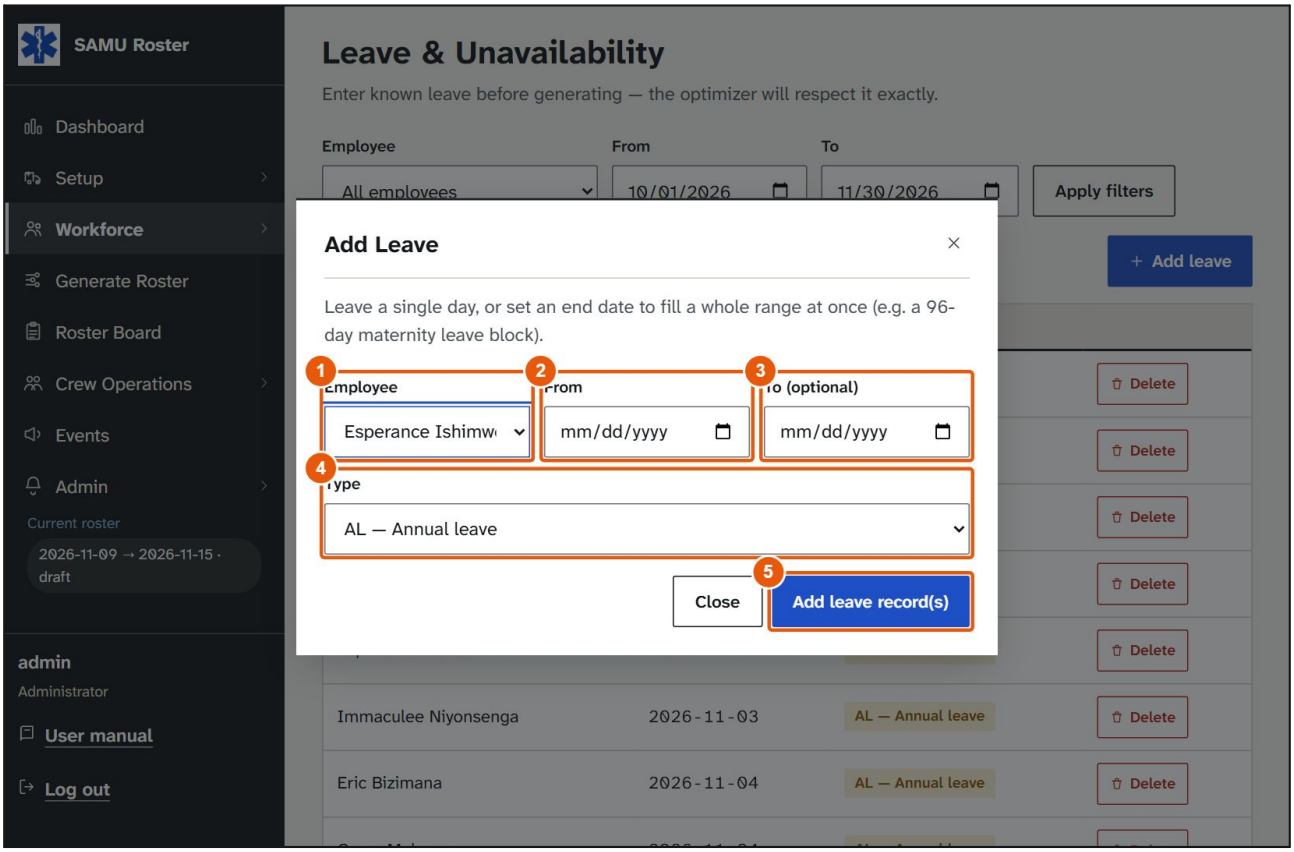
Leave is respected exactly by the roster generator.



1	Filter by employee and dates, then Apply filters.
2	Add leave.
3	Delete a wrong day.

Add leave

One record is created for each day in the range.



1	Employee
2	From
3	To (optional): leave empty for a single day
4	Type
5	Press Add leave record(s).

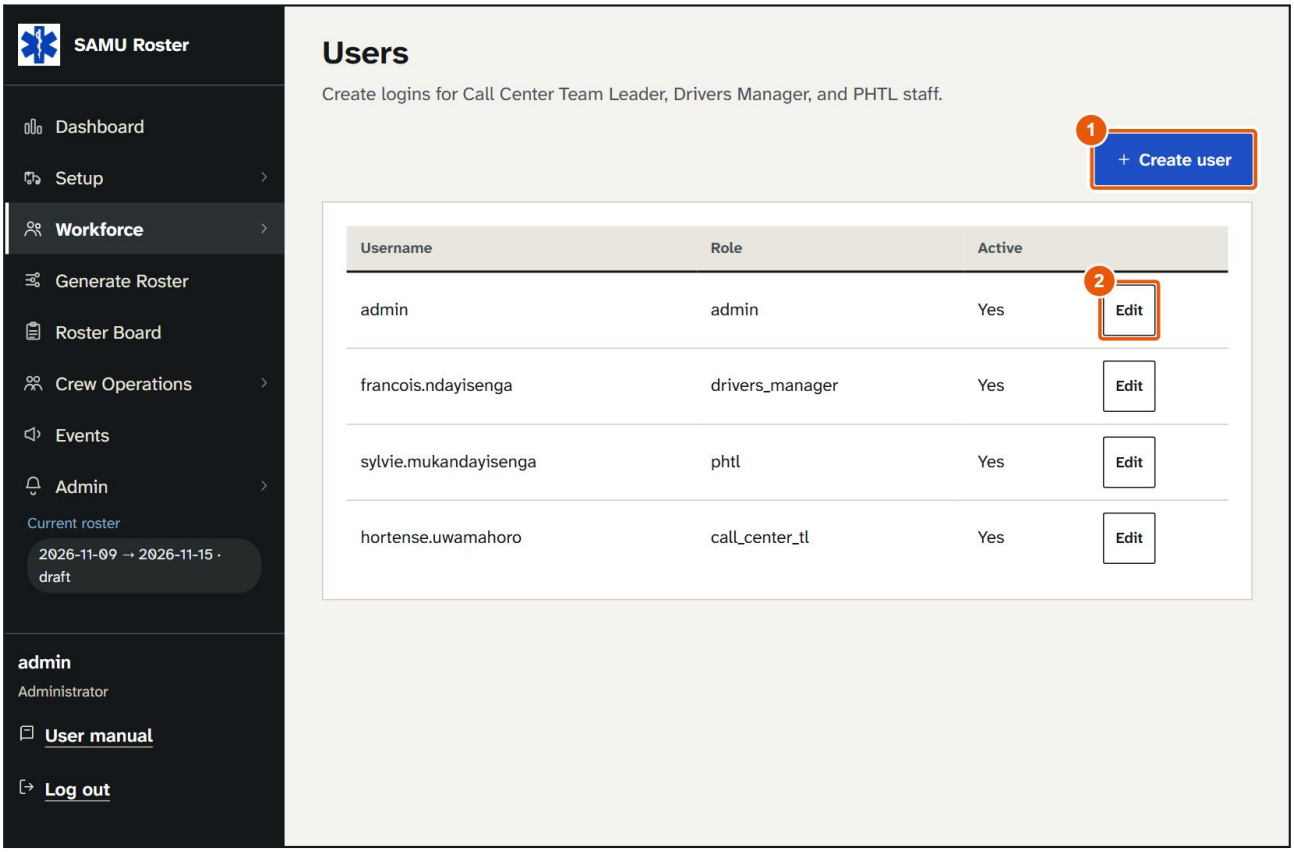
Maternity leave (96 days) and paternity leave (7 days) show a warning when a block runs longer, but are never refused. Delete a wrong day from the list.

6. Users

Workforce > Users: create accounts for the four roles. The password needs at least 8 characters, not only digits, not a common password. **Edit** a person to reset a password, change a role or deactivate them. The last active administrator can never be removed or demoted.

Users

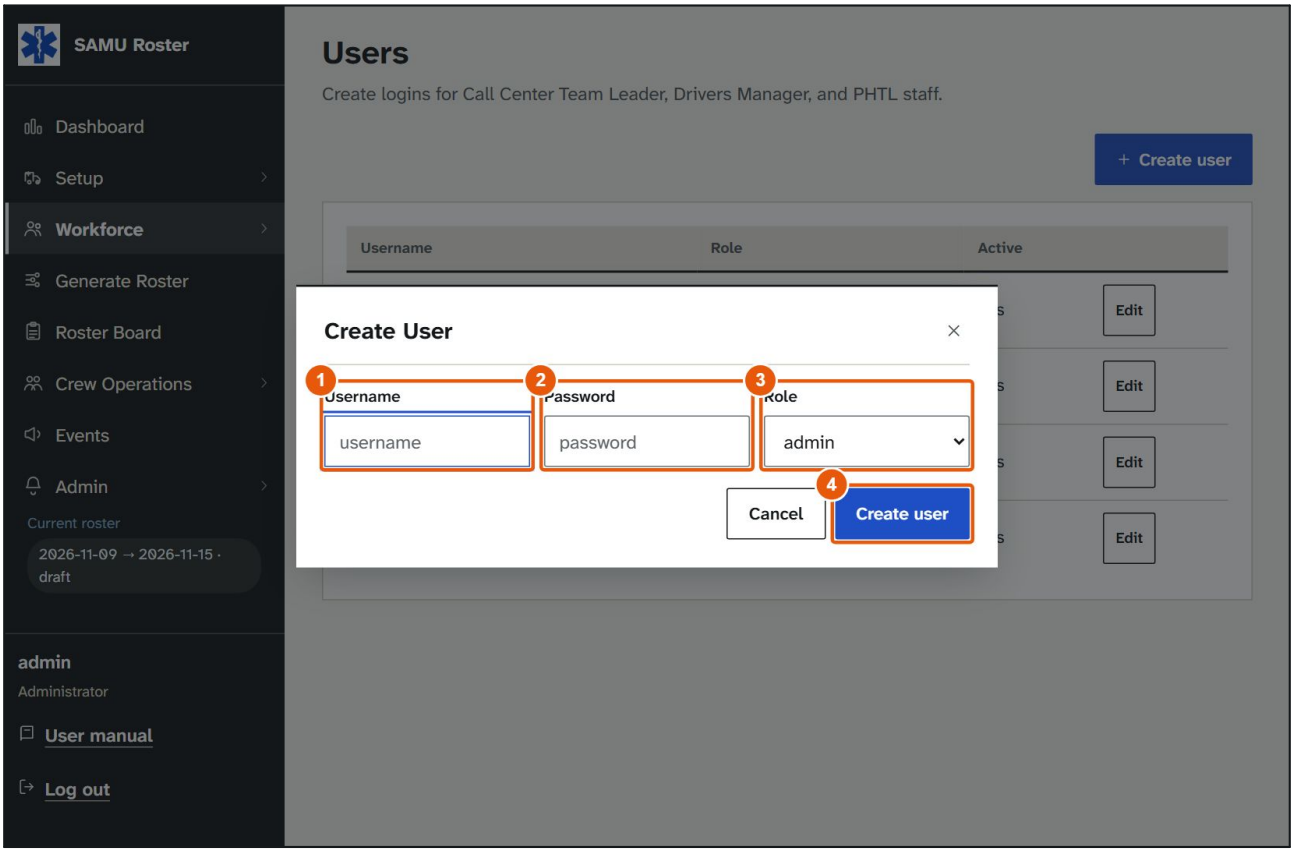
Accounts for the four roles.



1	Create user.
2	Edit: reset a password, change a role, or deactivate someone.

Create a user

The password needs at least 8 characters, not only digits, not a common password.



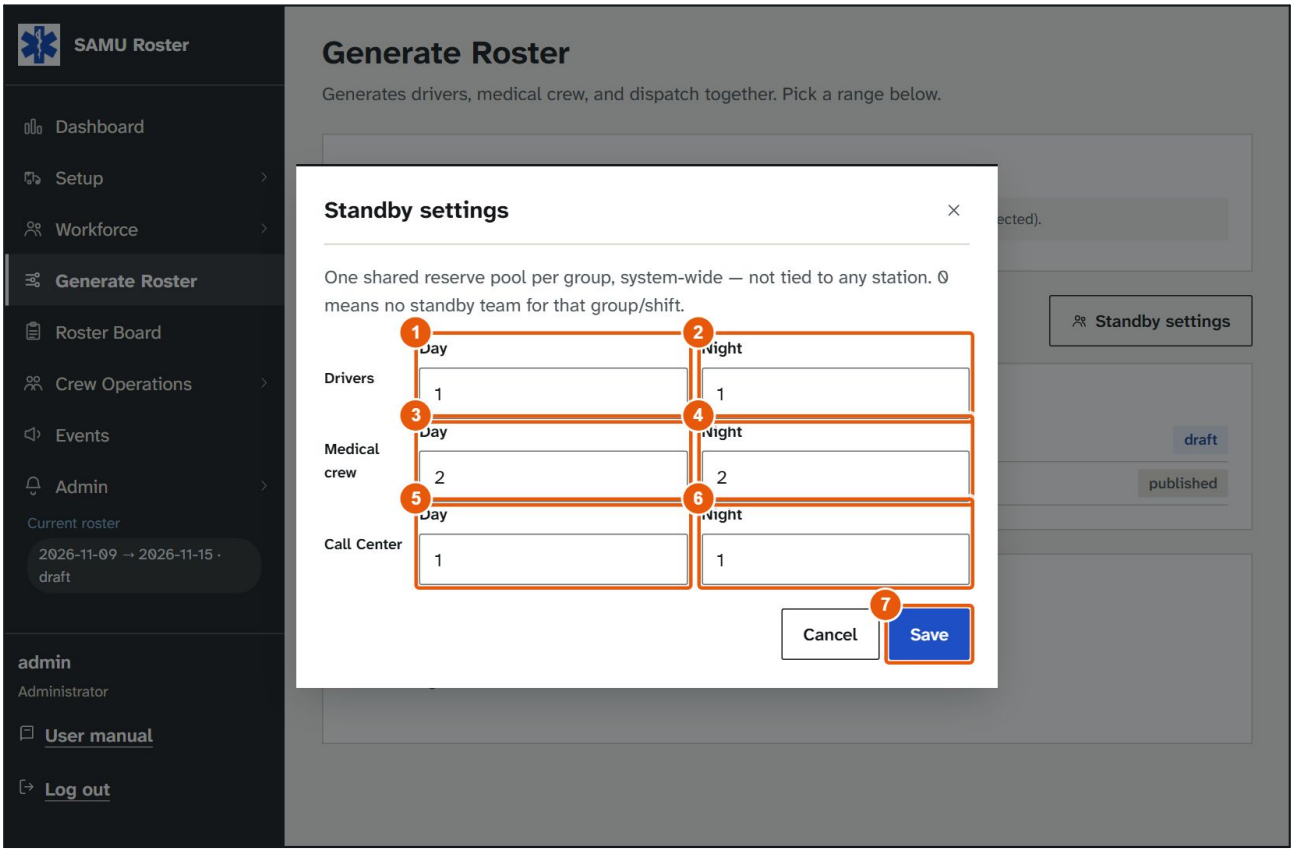
1	Username
2	Password
3	Role
4	Press Create user.

7. Standby settings

On **Generate Roster** press **Standby settings** to set how many reserve people each group (drivers, medical, call centre) keeps per day shift and per night shift. Zero means no standby team for that group.

Standby settings

How many reserve people each group keeps for each day and night shift. Zero means none.



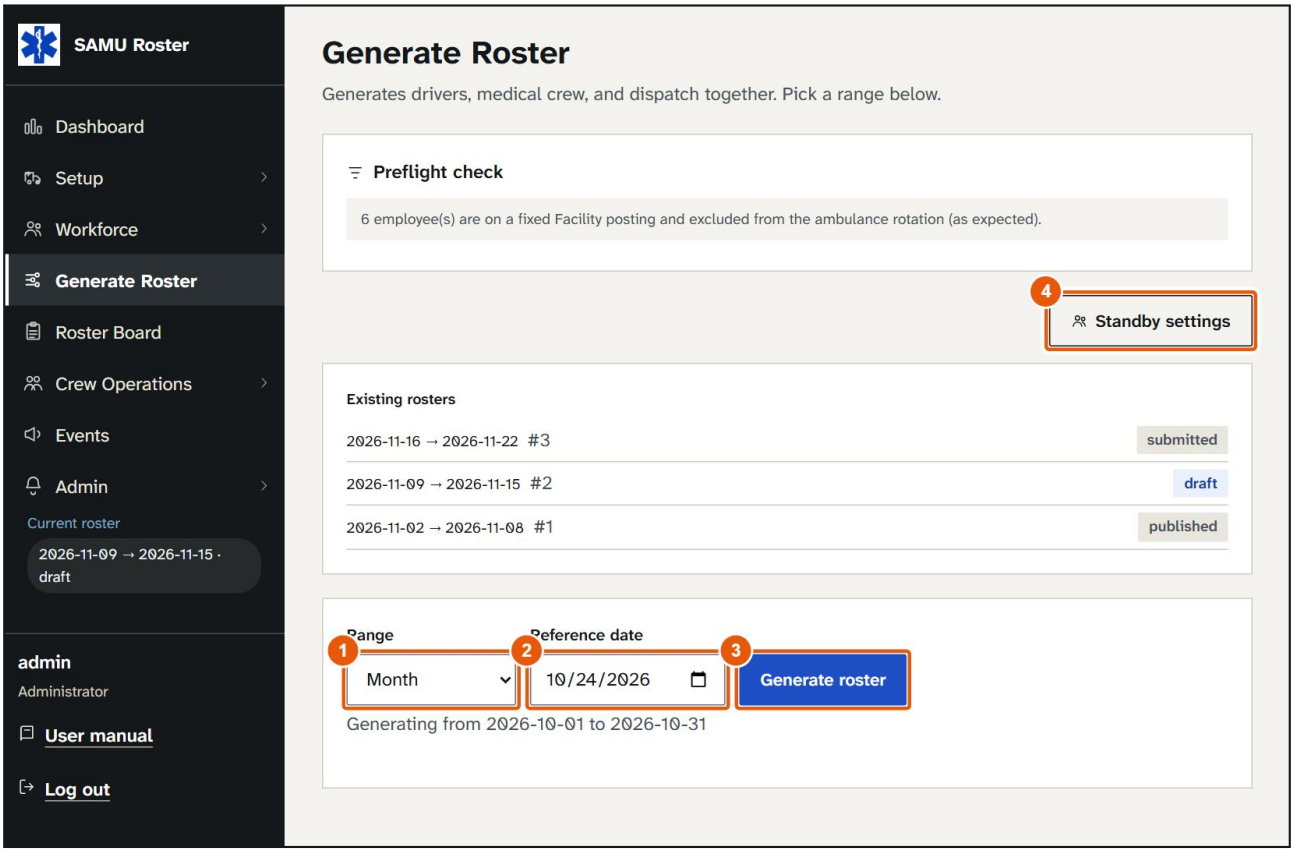
1	Day
2	Night
3	Day
4	Night
5	Day
6	Night
7	Press Save.

Generating the roster

As administrator you build drivers, medical crew and the dispatch desk in one go. The three managers can also each generate their own part into the same draft.

Generate Roster

Admin builds drivers, medical crew and the dispatch desk together.



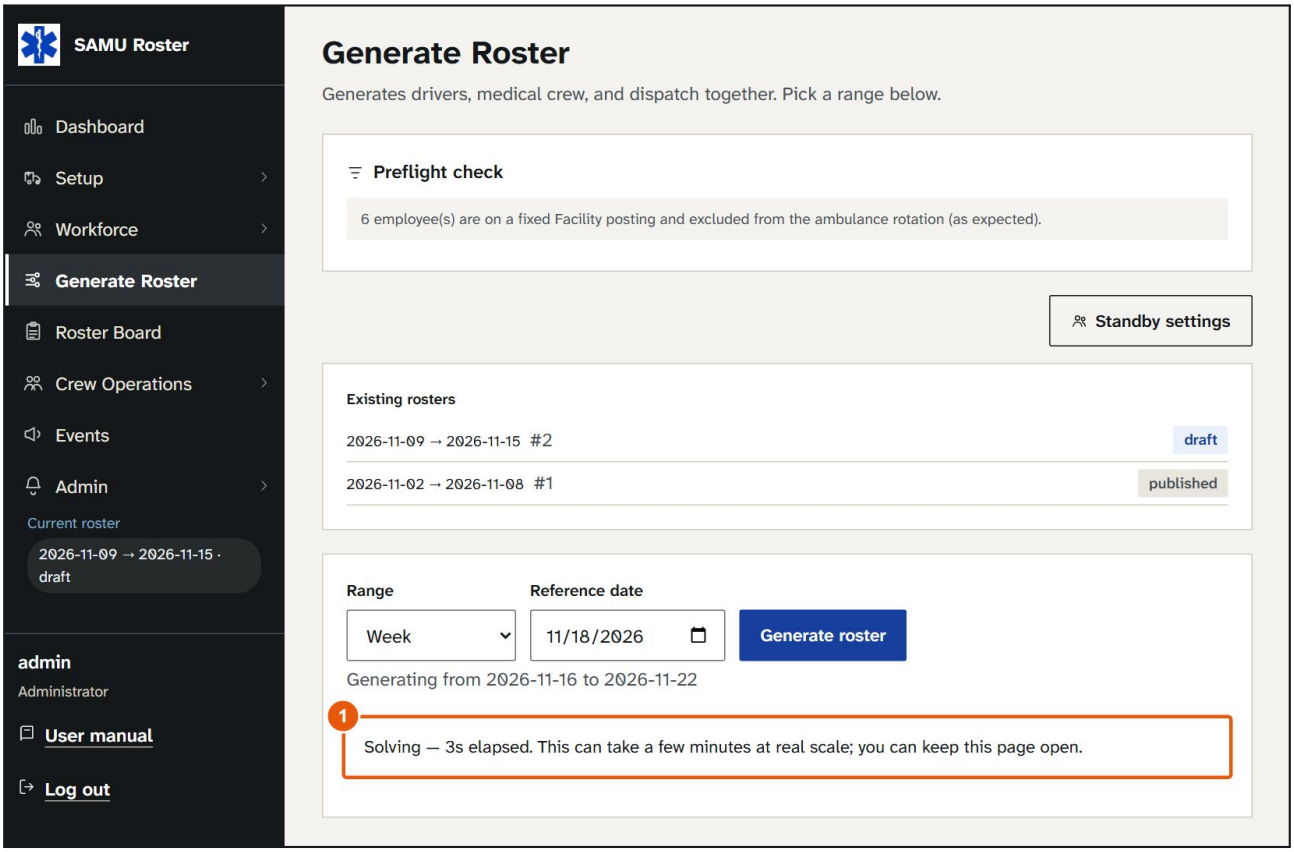
1	Range: Day, Week, Month or Custom range.
2	Reference date: the range is built around this date; the exact dates are shown below.
3	Generate roster: starts the build.
4	Standby settings (administrator): how many reserve people each group keeps.

1. Read the **Preflight check**. Fix blocking problems first; you can still choose **Generate anyway**, but the result will be poor.
2. Choose the **Range** (Day, Week, Month or Custom range) and the **Reference date**. The page shows the exact dates it will build.
3. Press **Generate roster**. The page shows **Solving - elapsed time**. A full roster takes about **10 to 15 minutes**. You can keep the page open or come back later.
4. When it finishes you see the number of assignments, an **Overall quality** score and an **Overtime** indicator, and any coverage gaps.

- **Standby settings** (administrator only) sets the reserve teams.
- Choosing exactly the same dates as an existing draft adds to that draft. Dates that only partly overlap another roster are refused.

While the roster is being built

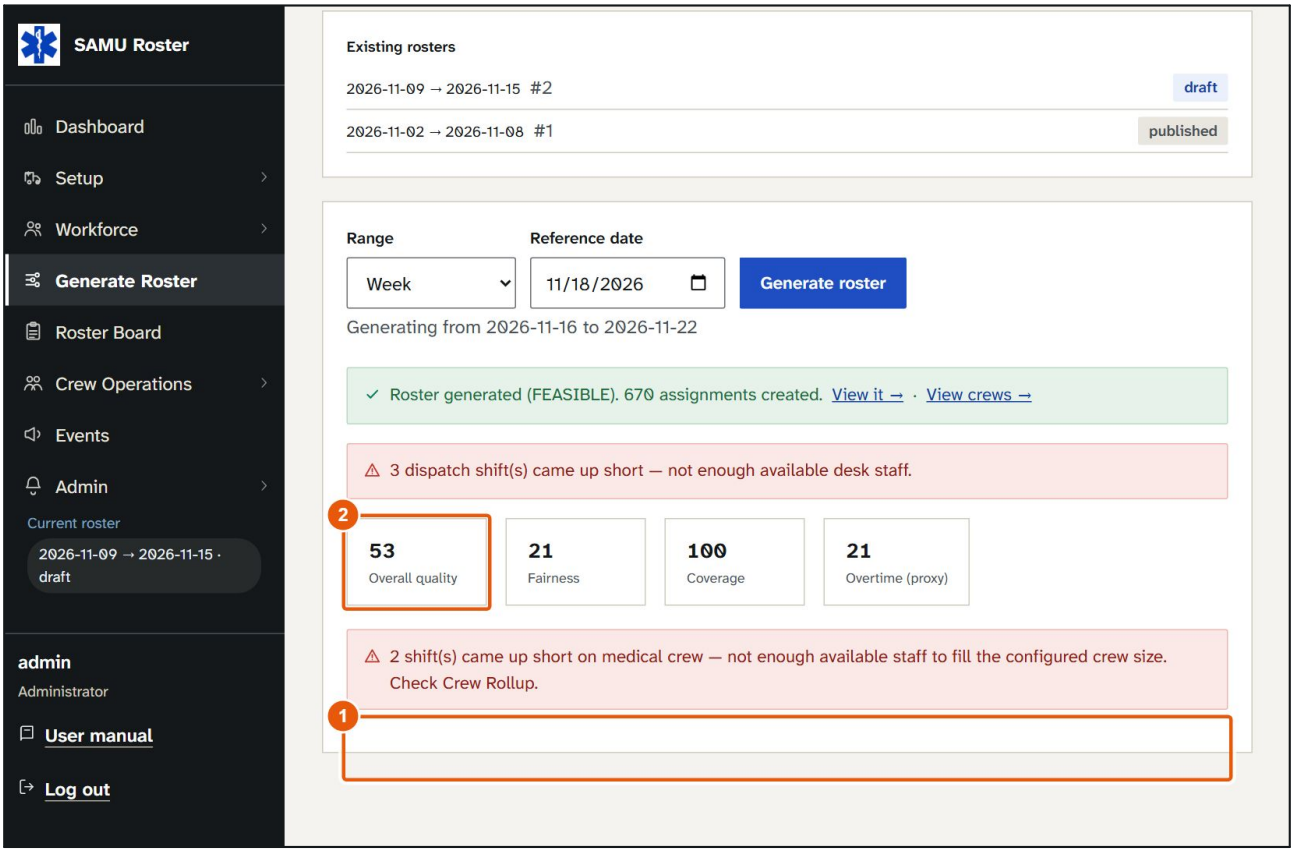
A full roster takes about 10 to 15 minutes. You can keep this page open or come back later.



1 The elapsed time. Do not press Generate again.

When it finishes

The result shows how good the roster is and what is still missing.



1	How many assignments were created.
2	Overall quality and an overtime indicator.

How a roster moves from draft to published

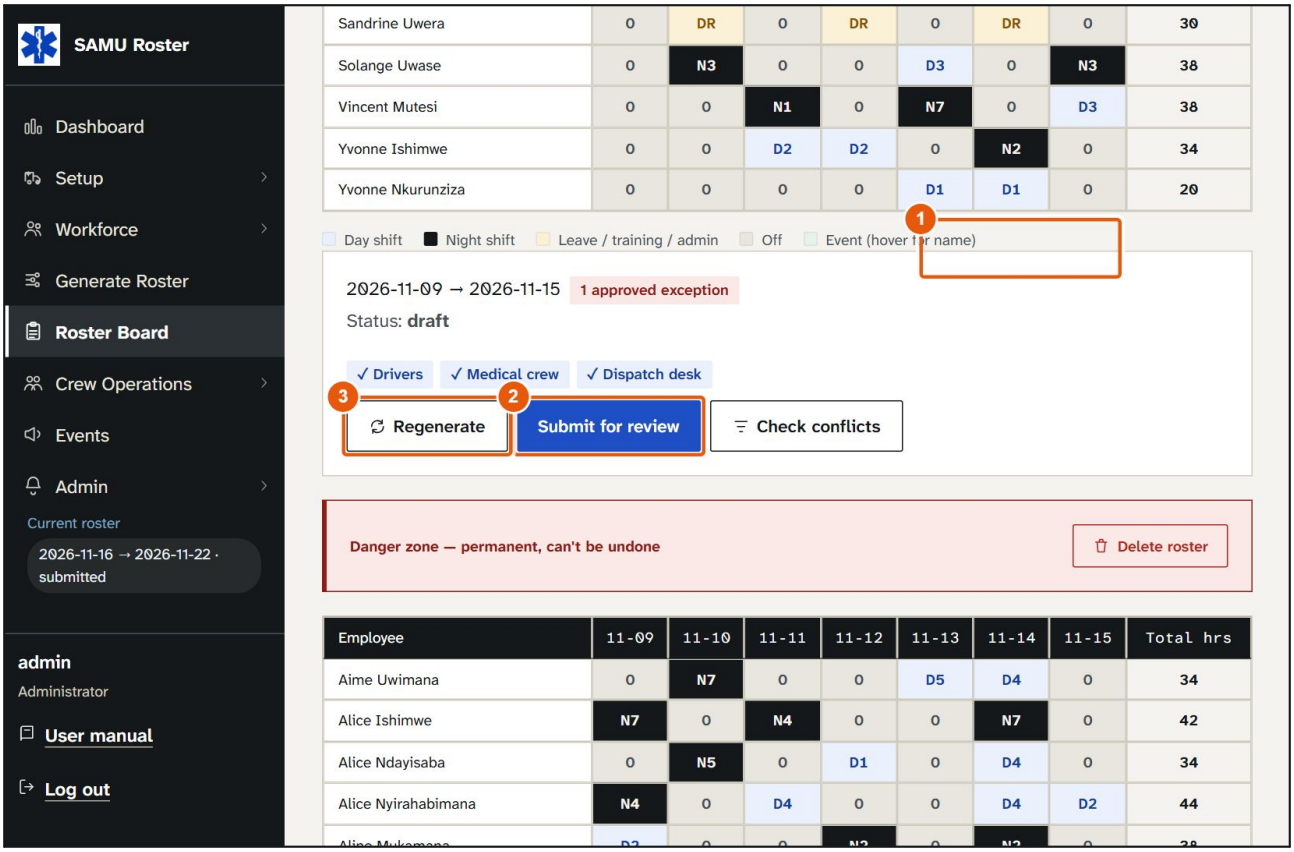
Stage	What it means	Who acts
Draft	Being built. The three parts (drivers, medical crew, dispatch desk) can each be generated into the same draft.	Administrator and the three managers
Submitted	Sent for review. It is locked: nobody can generate into it.	Anyone signed in; an administrator can reopen it
Published	Final. Every person in it is notified. Later changes go through crew replacements, which notify the people affected.	Administrator only

Checking and submitting a roster

Open **Roster Board** and choose the roster. While it is a draft you see these buttons above the grid.

What you can do with a draft roster

These buttons appear above the grid while the roster is a draft.

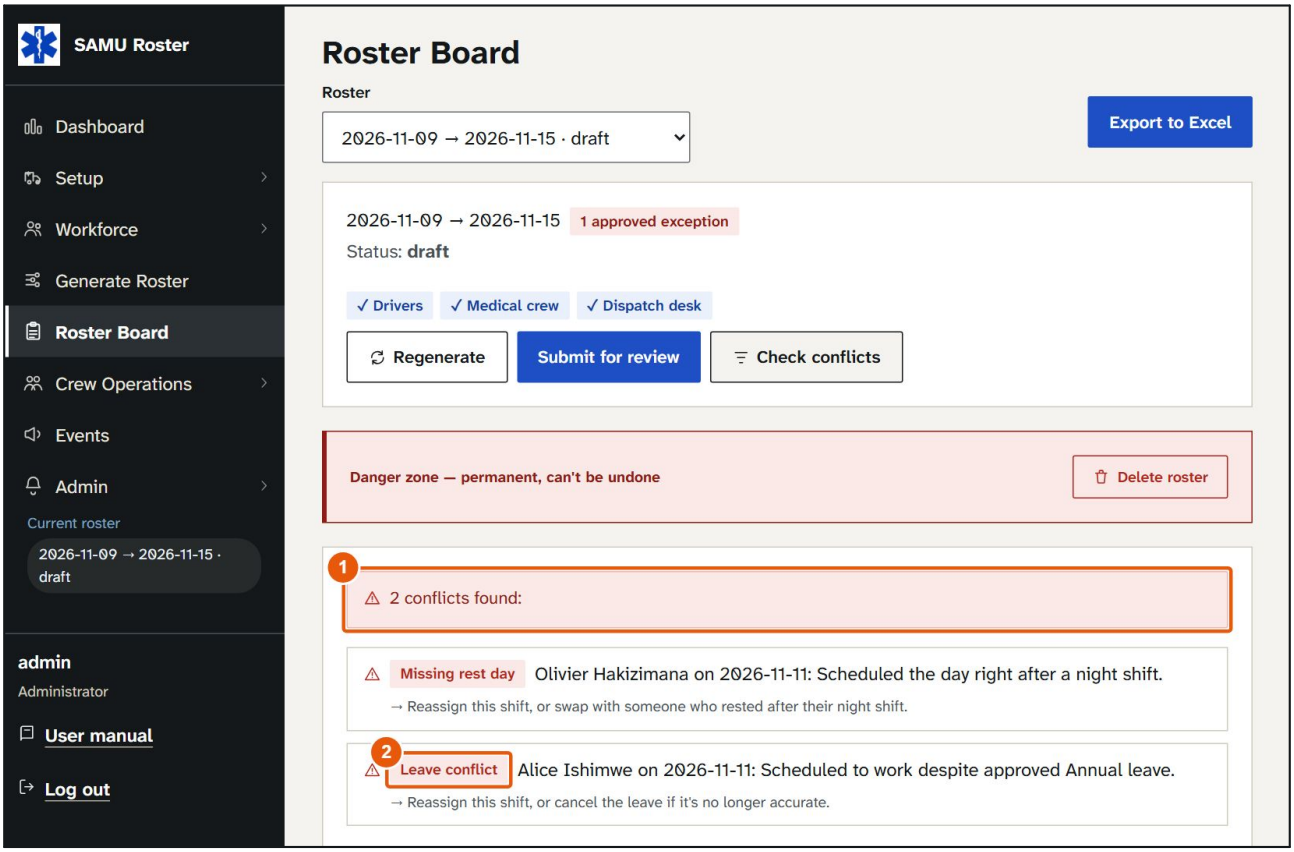


1	Check conflicts: lists anything that would block publishing.
2	Submit for review: sends the roster on when your part is ready.
3	Regenerate: rebuilds only your part of this draft.

Check conflicts lists everything that would block publishing: a missing rest day, a person scheduled while inactive, a night shift for someone not cleared for nights, a leave day that was overridden, a crew with no Pro, or an ambulance that is not in service. Each line says how to fix it.

Check conflicts

Each line says what is wrong and how to fix it. Items marked Approved exception were signed off by a manager and do not block publishing.



1	The headline: how many conflicts and approved exceptions were found.
2	A conflict that blocks publishing: it names the person, the day and how to fix it.

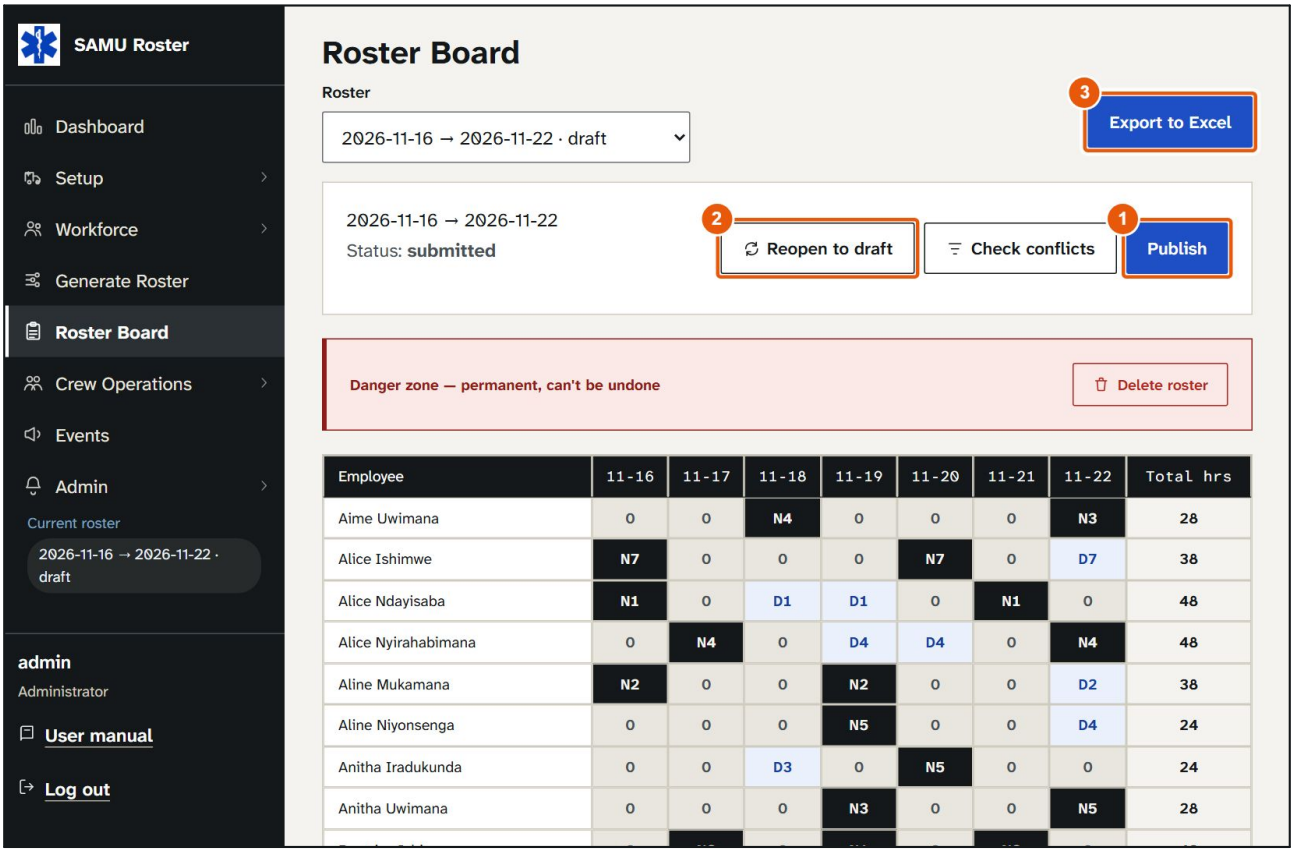
An item marked **Approved exception** was a deliberate rule break signed off by a manager, with a reason. It does not block publishing.

Submitting and publishing

1. Press **Submit for review**. You are warned if a part (drivers, medical crew, dispatch desk) was never generated.
2. Press **Publish**. It is refused while conflicts remain. Everyone in the roster is notified, including standby duty.
3. **Reopen to draft** returns a submitted roster to draft so a missing part can be generated. **Export to Excel** saves the grid as a spreadsheet.

A submitted roster

Once submitted, the roster is locked. The administrator publishes it, or reopens it if a part is missing.



1	Publish: makes the roster final and notifies everyone in it. It is refused while conflicts remain.
2	Reopen to draft: returns it to draft so a missing part can be generated.
3	Export to Excel.

- **Regenerate** rebuilds a draft (all parts).
- **Delete roster** is permanent. A submitted or published roster needs you to type its status to confirm.

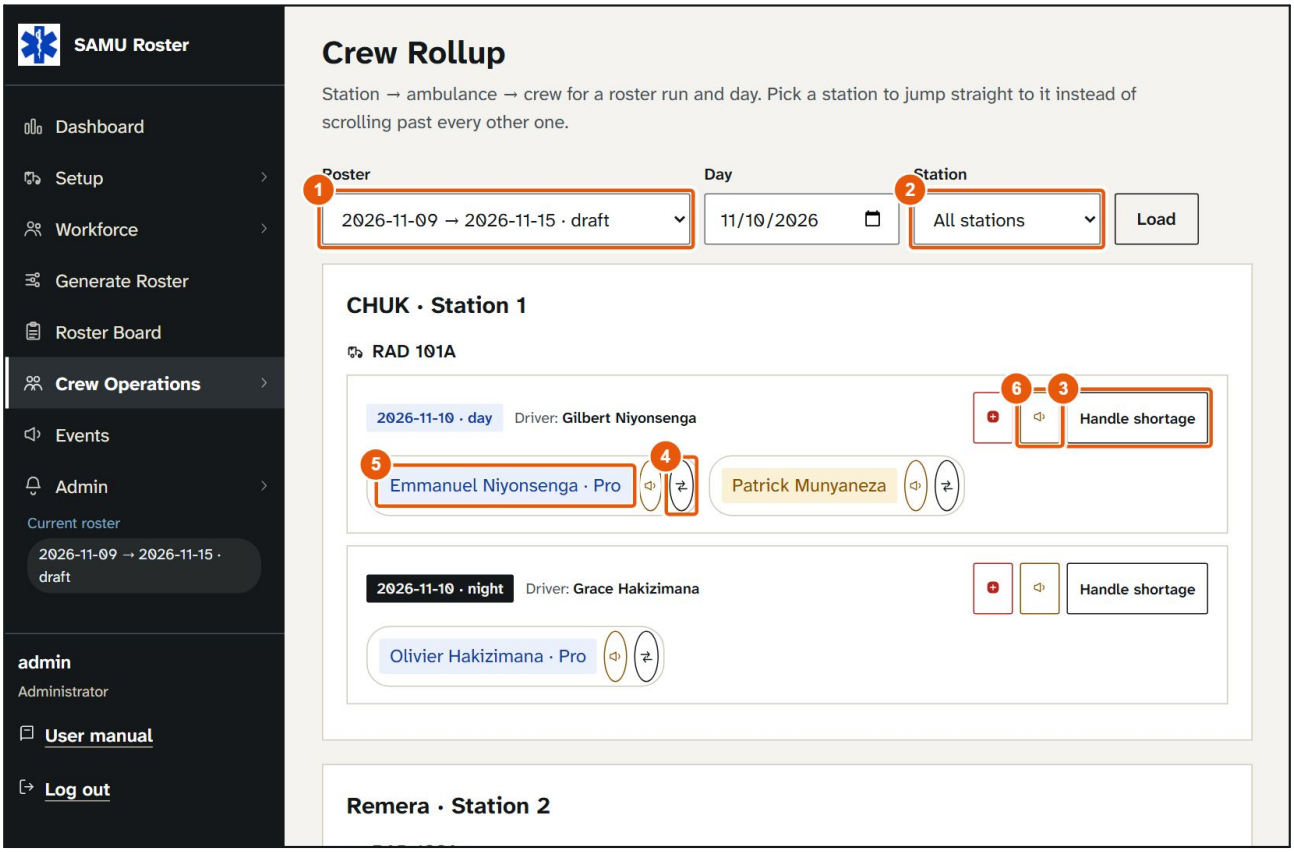
Changes after the roster exists

Crew Rollup: see and change a crew

Crew Operations > Crew Rollup shows station, ambulance and crew for one roster and one day. Choose the station to jump to it.

Crew Rollup

Station, ambulance and crew for one roster and one day.



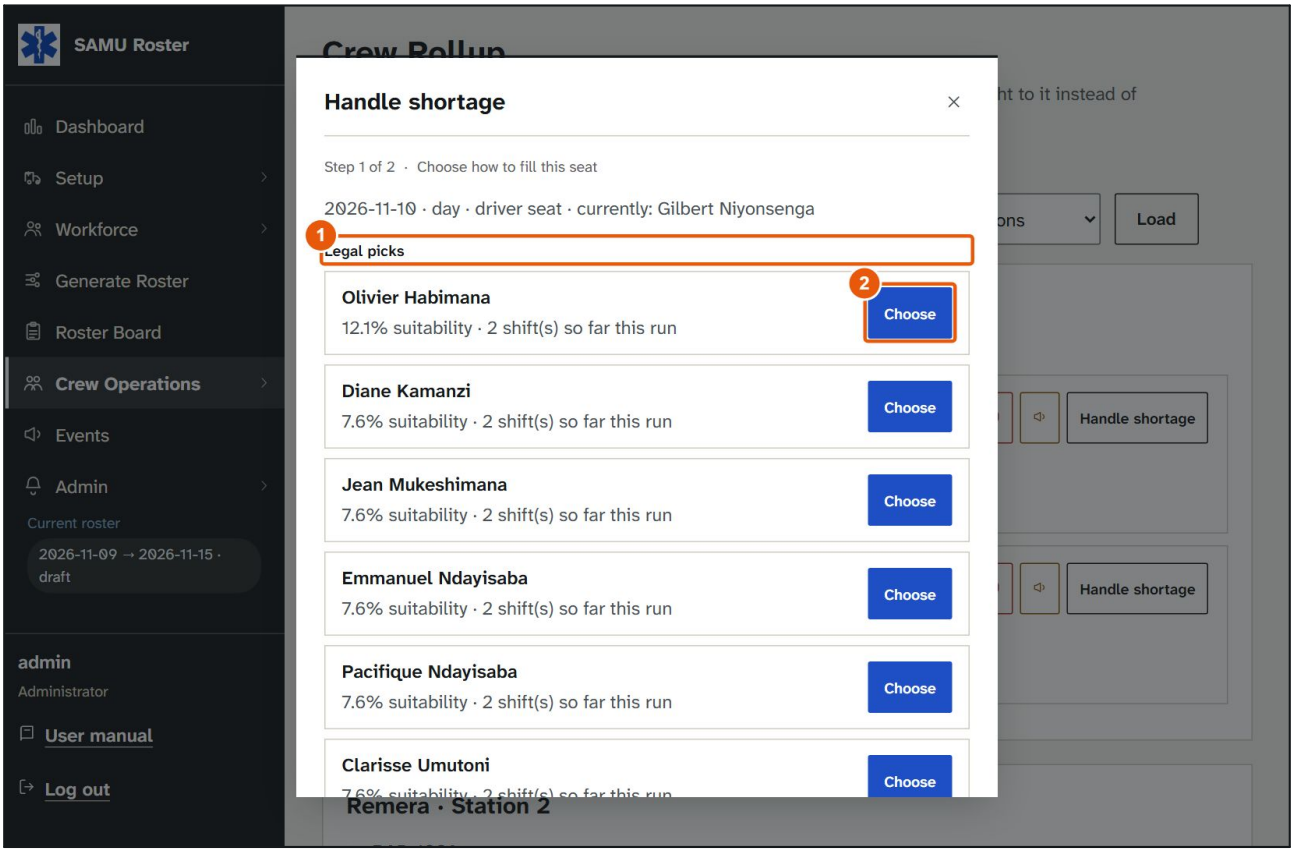
1	Choose the roster.
2	Choose the station to jump to it.
3	Handle shortage on the driver: replace the driver or accept the gap.
4	The swap button next to a crew member: replace that person or accept a short crew.
5	Click a Pro's name to make them crew leader.
6	The calendar-style button: pull this person off the crew for an event.

Replacing someone or accepting a gap: Handle shortage

1. Open **Crew Rollup**, choose the roster and the day, then pick the station. Each ambulance shift is a card.
2. Press **Handle shortage** on the ambulance shift (it is next to the driver). A window opens: **Choose how to fill this seat**.
3. Under **Legal picks**, choose a person. Candidates are ranked by fairness, least-loaded first. Press **Confirm crew replacement**. Both people are notified if the roster is already published.
4. If nobody is legal, **Risky picks - needs an override** lists people who would break a protected rule (for example a rest day or Pro coverage). Choose a reason, write a justification and type **OVERRIDE** to confirm.
5. If nobody can be found, under **Or: leave this crew short** press **Approve this crew to run with no driver**. Choose a reason and write a justification. Nobody is moved; the gap is accepted and logged.

Handle shortage: choose how to fill the seat

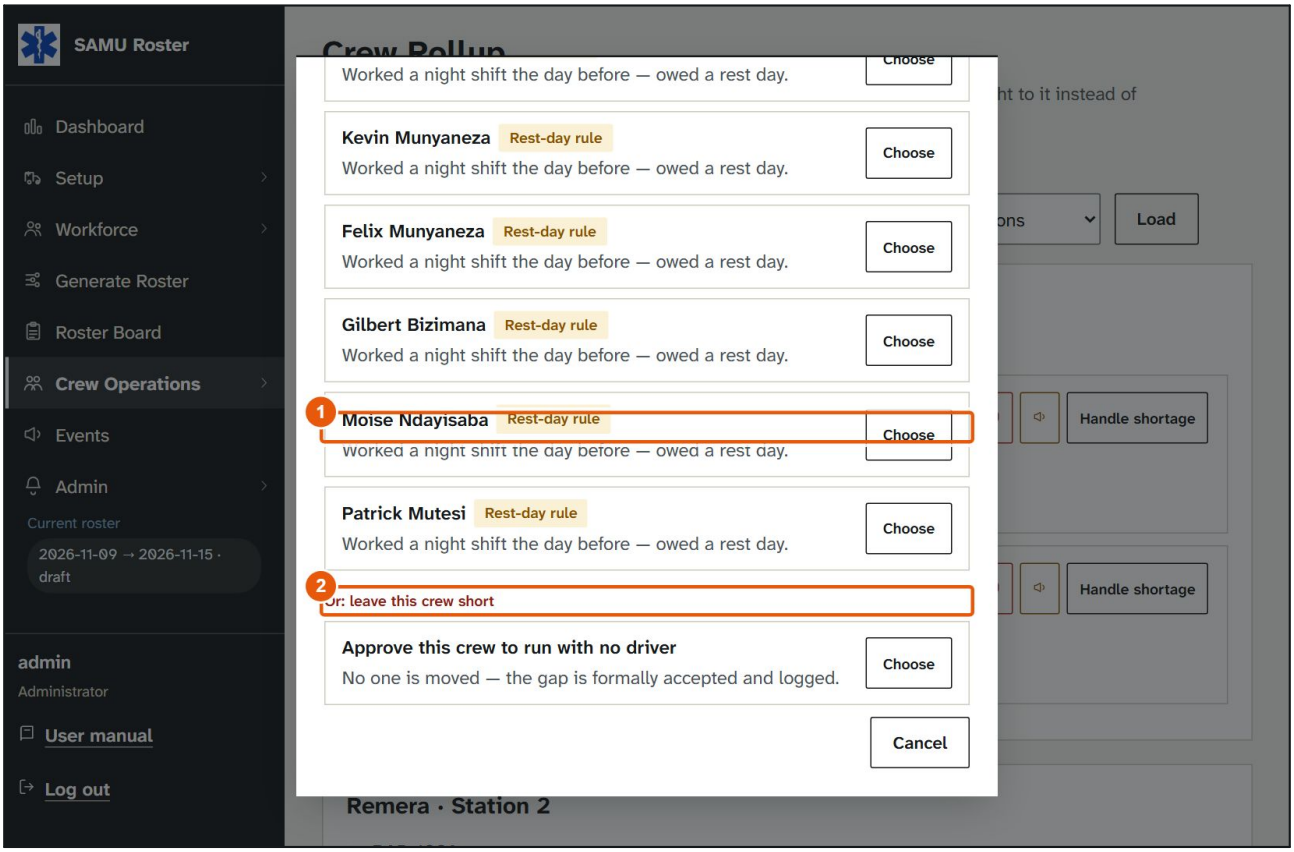
The window opens on the legal picks, ranked by fairness. Scroll down for the other two options.



1	Legal picks: people who break no rule, ranked by fairness (least-loaded first).
2	Choose a person, then confirm the replacement in the next step.

Handle shortage: risky picks, or leave the crew short

Further down the same window.



1	Risky picks - needs an override: people who would break a protected rule, such as a rest day. You must give a reason, write a justification and type OVERRIDE to confirm.
2	Or: leave this crew short. Nobody is moved; the gap is accepted and logged with your reason.

> **IMPORTANT** Every risky pick and every accepted shortage is recorded under **Command Decisions** with your name, the reason and the justification. Safety-related ones are reviewed by the administrator.

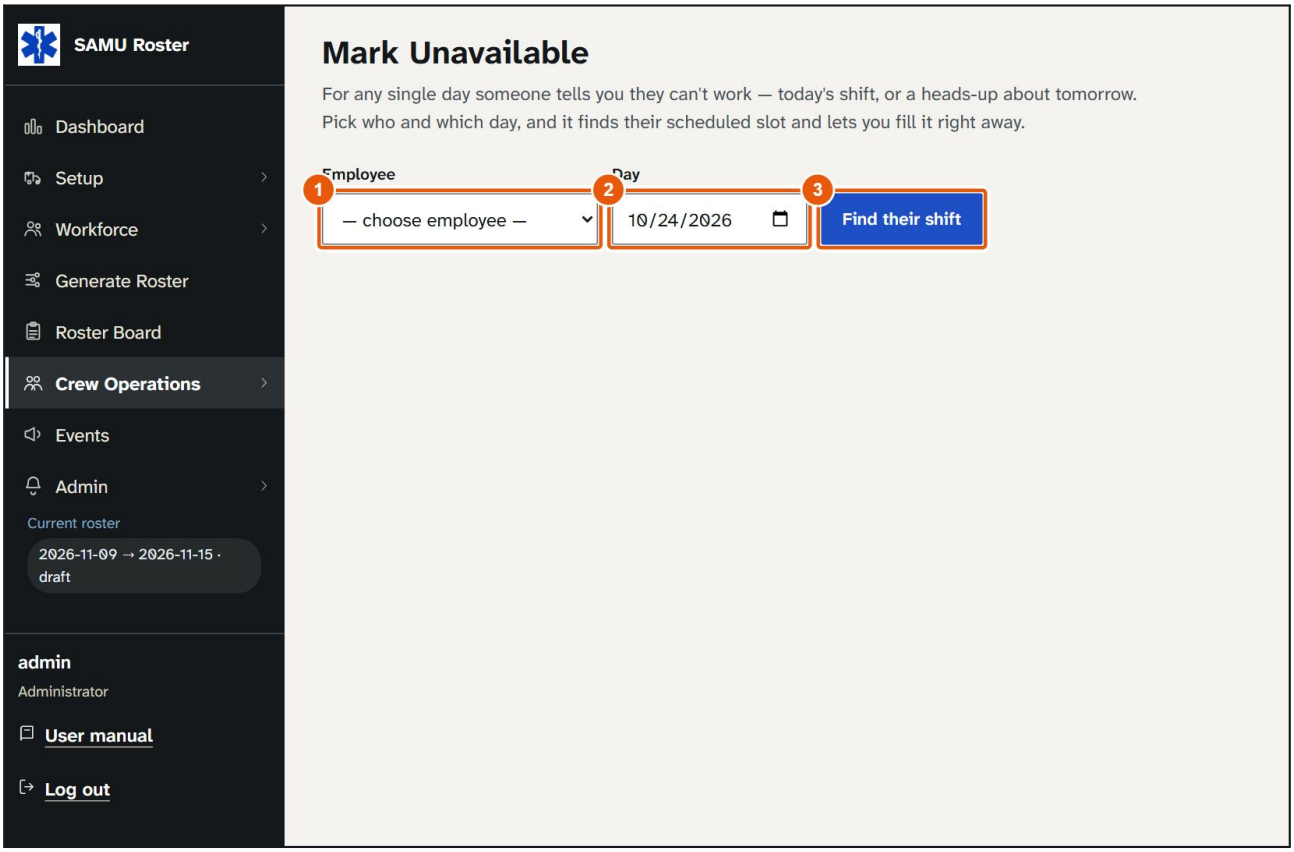
For a **medical crew member**, press the swap button next to their name instead; the steps are the same, and the last option reads **Approve this crew to run short**. Click a Pro member's name to make them **crew leader**. The calendar-style button next to a person is **Pull for event**: it takes them off their crew and leaves it short, with no replacement.

Mark Unavailable

For one day when someone cannot work: **Crew Operations > Mark Unavailable** (or the red button next to a person in Crew Rollup or Employees). Choose the person and the day, press **Find their shift**, then fill the slot immediately.

Mark Unavailable

For a single day when someone cannot work.



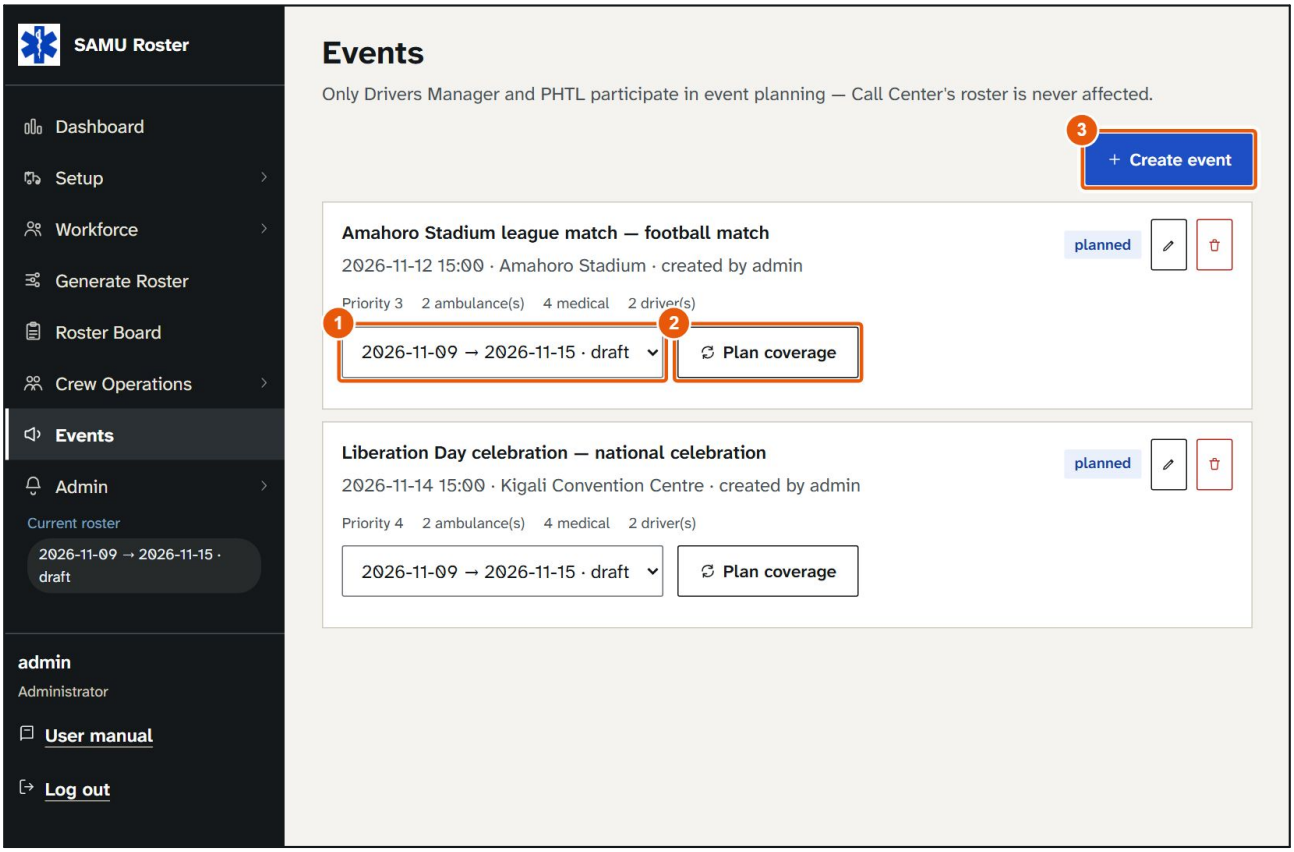
1	Choose the person.
2	Choose the day.
3	Find their shift: shows their slot so you can fill it straight away.

Planning event coverage

Events lists events that need extra ambulances and crews. Only the administrator creates events; the Drivers Manager and PHTL plan their coverage. The Call Center is never affected.

Events

Events that need extra ambulances and crews.

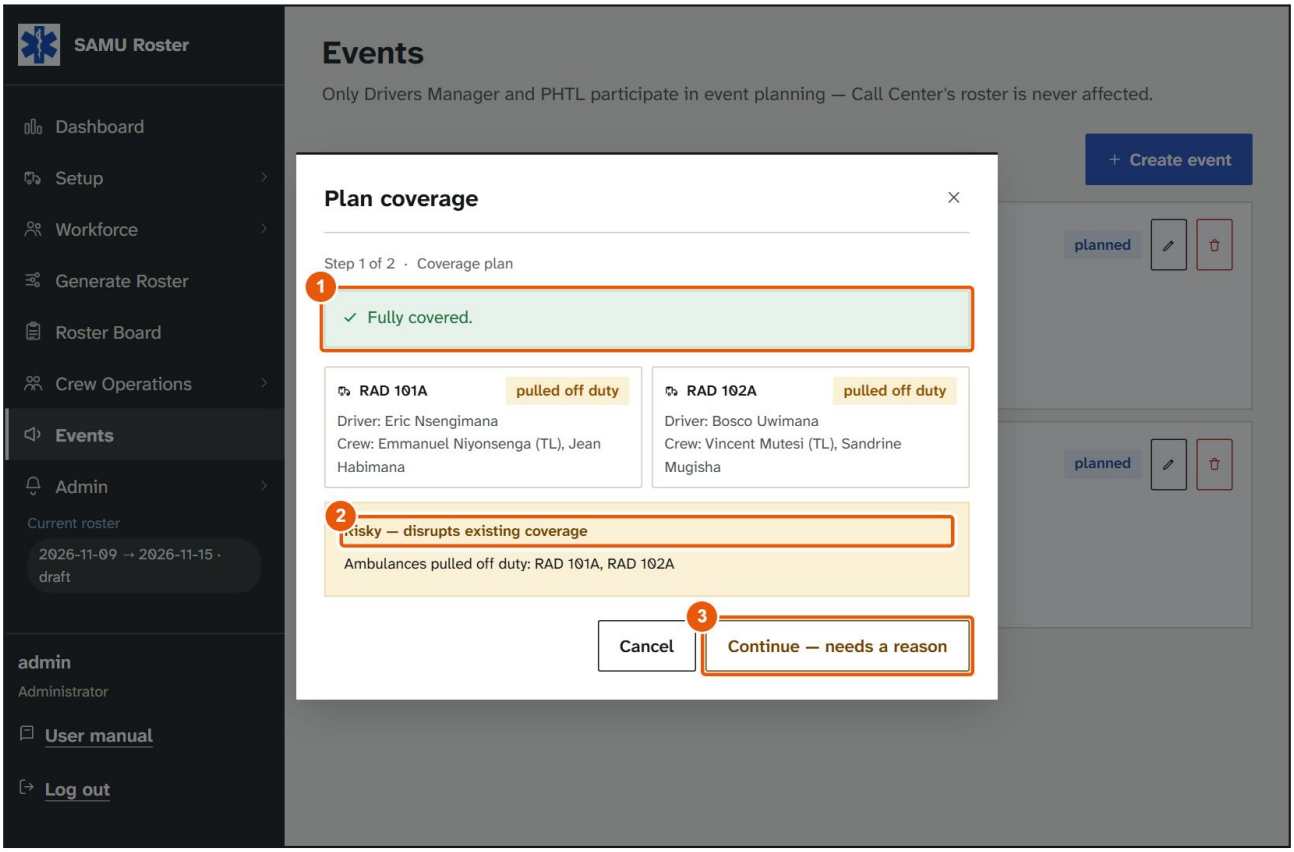


1	Choose the roster to plan against: it must cover the event date.
2	Plan coverage: the system proposes who covers the event.
3	Create event (administrator only).

1. Choose **Roster to plan against**. It must cover the event date; if none does, you are told to plan a roster for that week first.
2. Press **Plan coverage**. The system computes a **Coverage plan**: ambulances, drivers and medical crew, and any gaps (*Gaps remain* or *Fully covered*).
3. If the plan would disrupt existing coverage (pulling an ambulance, reassigning someone from a shift or from mandated rest) it is marked **Risky**. Press **Continue - needs a reason**, choose a reason, write a justification, then **Confirm & commit**.
4. A plan with no disruption is committed with **Commit this plan**.

Plan coverage

The proposed plan shows who covers the event and what is still missing.

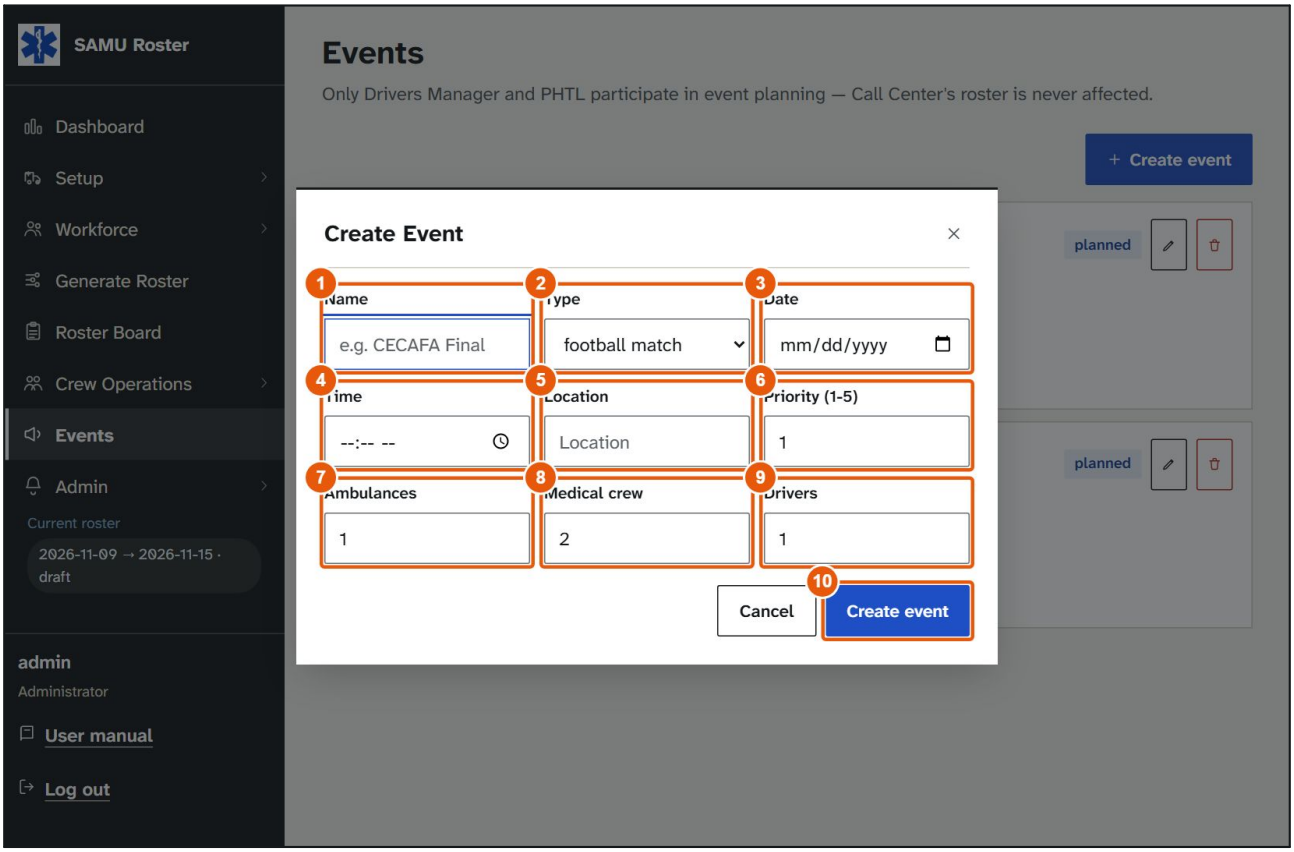


1	The headline says Fully covered, or how many ambulances, drivers or medical crew are still short.
2	A plan that disrupts regular coverage is marked Risky and needs a reason before it is committed.
3	Commit this plan when you accept it.

To **create an event**, press **Create event** and fill the form.

Create an event

Only the administrator creates events.



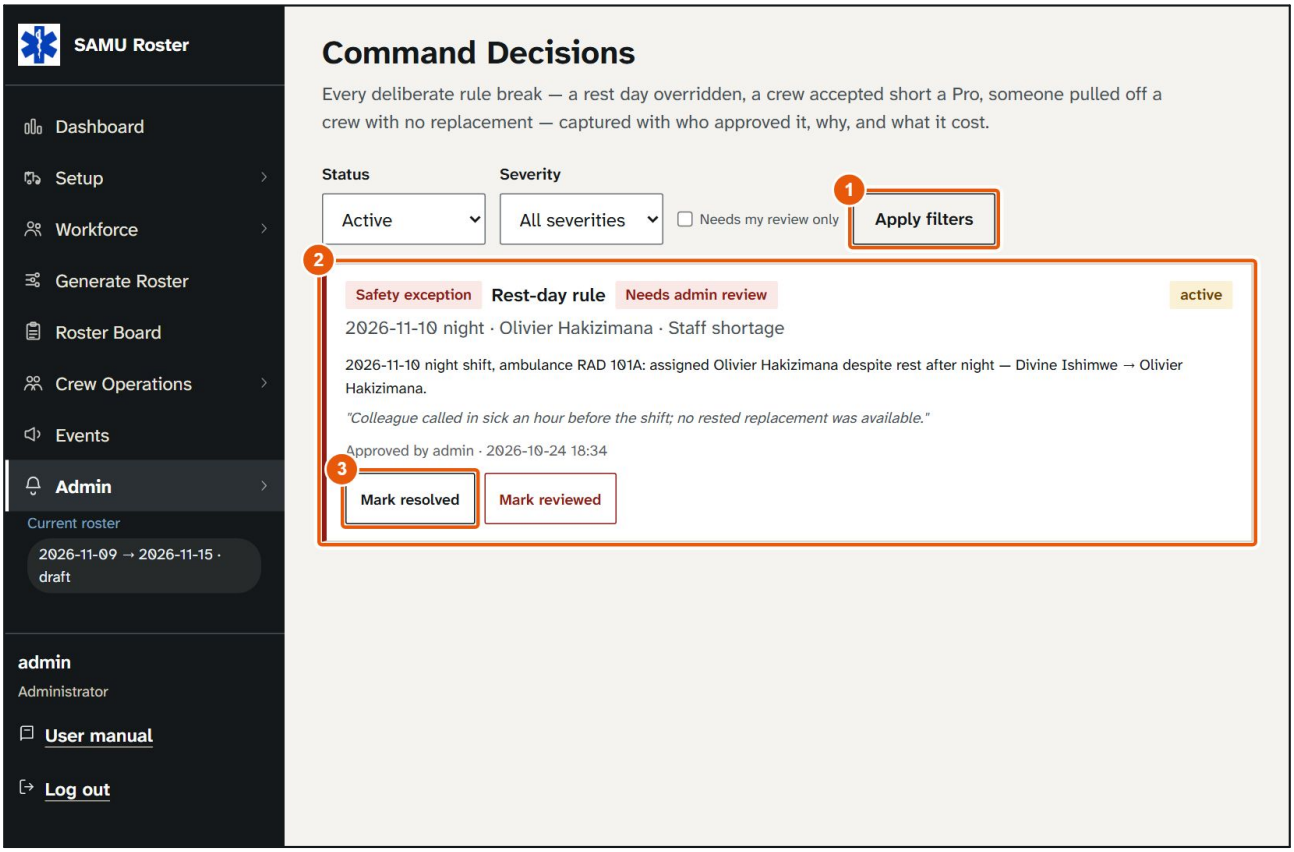
1	Name
2	Type
3	Date
4	Time
5	Location
6	Priority (1-5)
7	Ambulances
8	Medical crew
9	Drivers
10	Press Create event.

Command Decisions

Every deliberate rule break in the system: a rest day overridden, a crew accepted short of a Pro or a driver, someone pulled off a crew. Each shows who approved it, the reason and the written justification.

Command Decisions

Every deliberate rule break: who approved it, why, and what it cost.



1	Filters: narrow by status or severity.
2	Each decision shows the reason and the written justification.
3	Mark resolved when it is closed; the administrator also marks safety decisions reviewed.

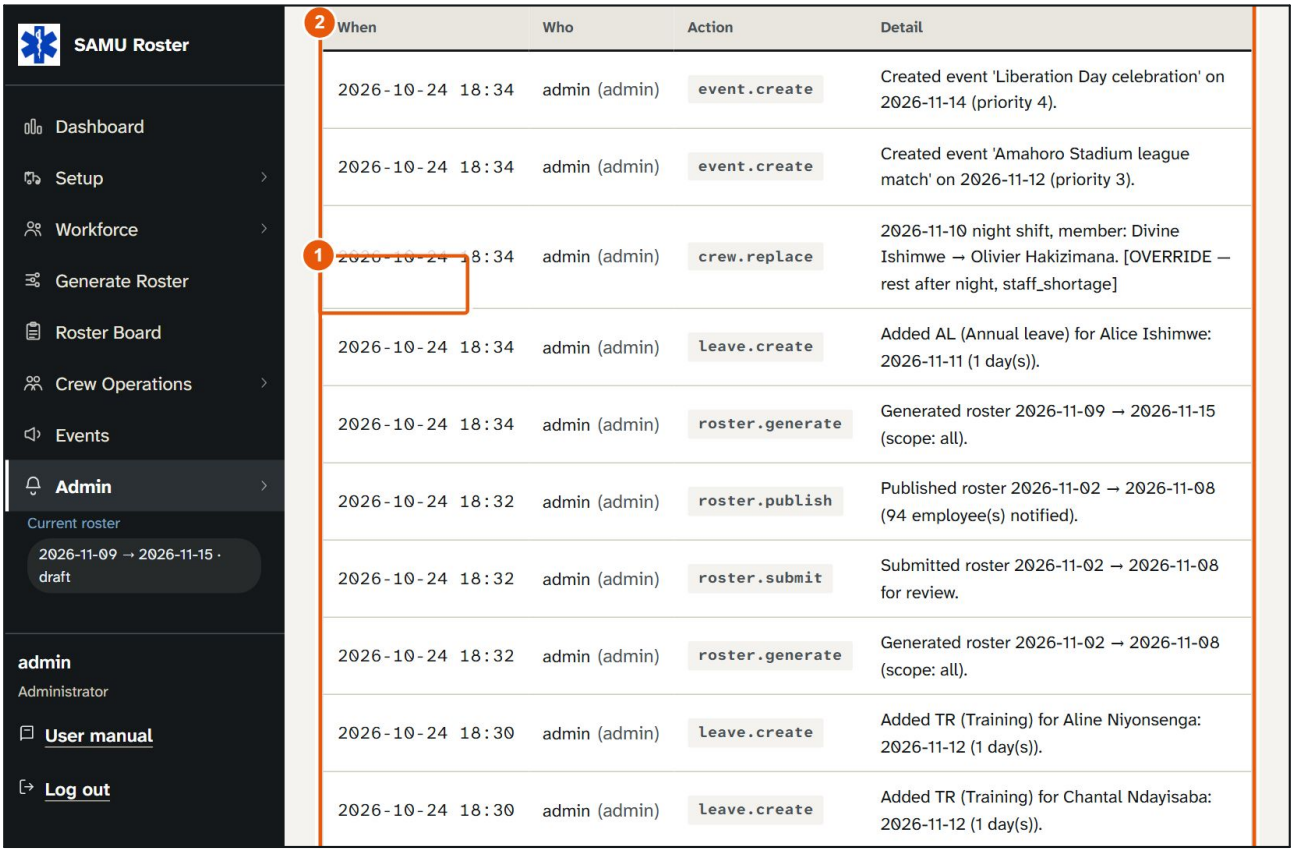
Press **Mark resolved** when a decision is closed. The administrator also marks safety decisions **reviewed**.

Activity Log and notifications

Activity Log shows who did what and when. Filter by person, action or dates, then press **Apply filters**.

Activity Log

Who did what and when.



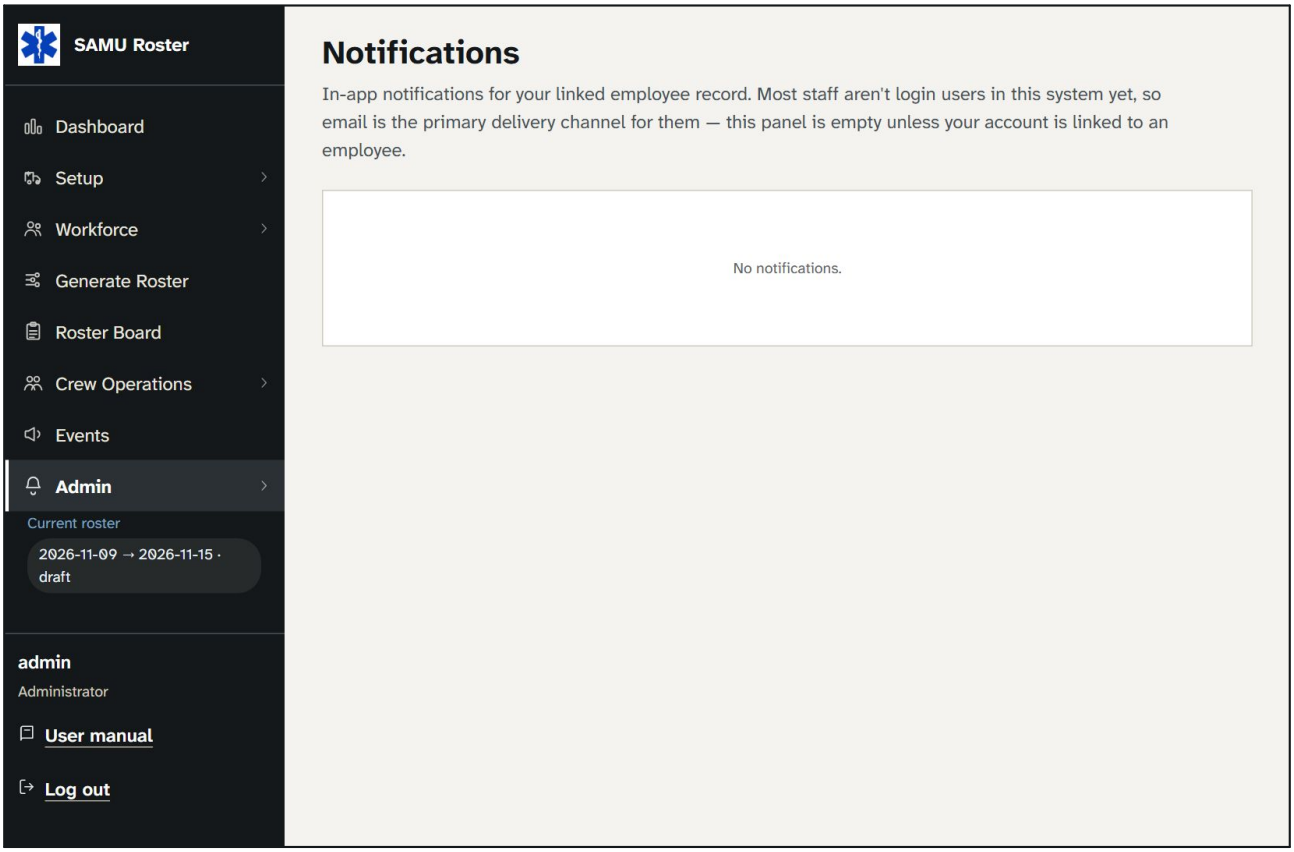
1	Filter by person, action or dates, then Apply filters.
2	Each line is one action, written as a sentence.

Notifications

Notifications lists messages sent to you, for example when a roster you are in is published or a crew change affects you. Press **Mark read** once you have seen one.

Notifications

Messages sent to you, for example when a roster is published or a crew change affects you.



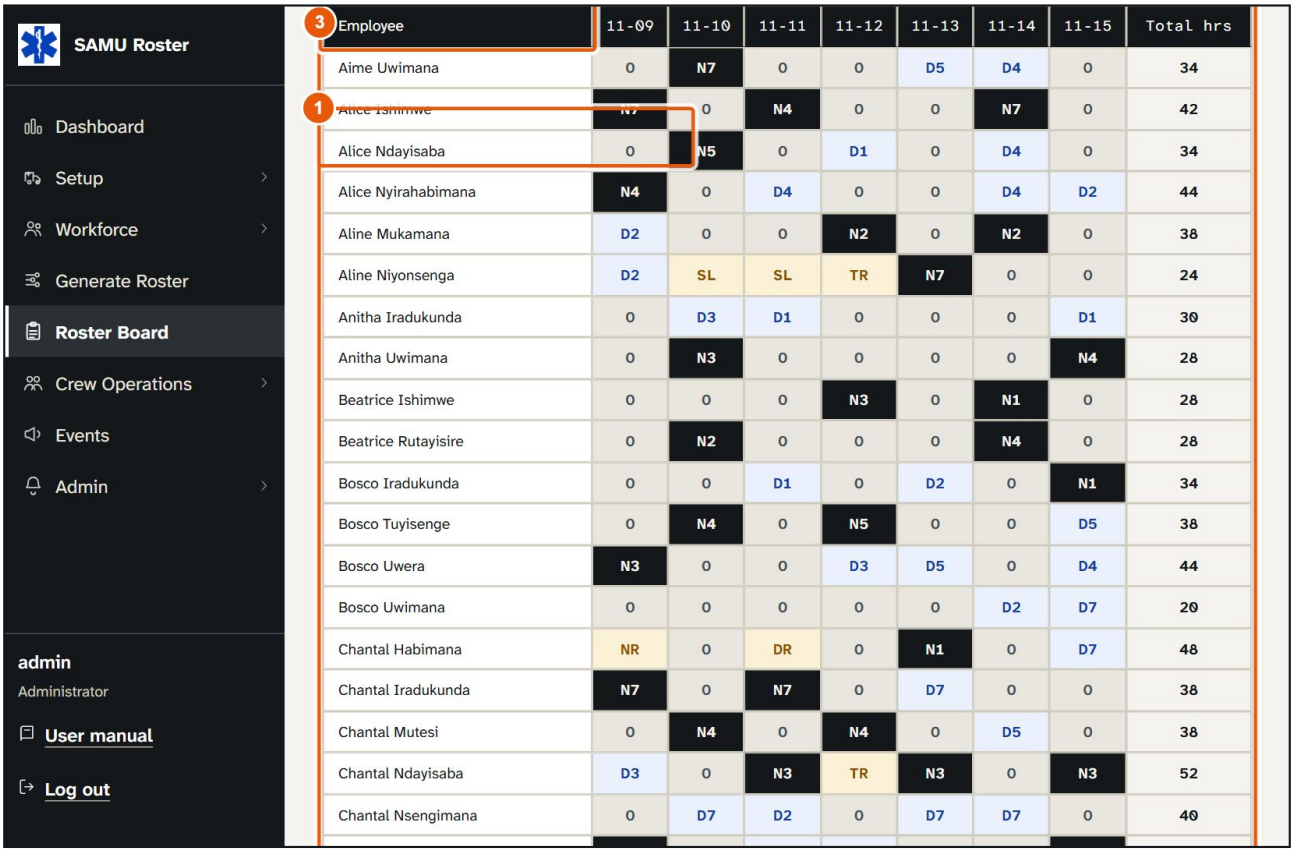
1 Each message shows what happened and when. None have arrived yet.

Reading the roster board

The board has one row per person and one column per day. Each cell holds a code. Blue-tinted cells are day shifts, dark cells are night shifts, grey cells are days off, amber cells are leave or other absence, green cells are event duty.

The Roster Board

One row per person and one column per day. Each cell holds a shift code.



1	Choose the roster. The status (draft, submitted or published) is shown below.
2	The grid: blue cells are day shifts, dark cells night shifts, grey cells days off, amber cells leave.
3	Scroll sideways to see every day. The name column stays in place.

Code	Meaning
D + number (D3)	Day shift at the station with that code
N + number (N3)	Night shift at the station with that code
DR / NR	Day / night shift at the Regulation desk (call centre desk)
DE / NE	Day / night event duty
O	Off
AL, SL, ML, PL	Annual leave, sick leave, maternity leave, paternity leave
TR, AD, P	Training, administration, permission
MS, ST, CY, CL	Mission, stock, cyclism, circumstance leave
DT, DM, DC, R	Data, day meeting, day checking, roster
SB	Standby

For fairness, a day shift counts as **10 hours** and a night shift as **14 hours**. The total at the right of each row is the hours worked in the roster.

Rules the system applies when it builds a roster

- One shift per person per day. Leave is respected exactly as entered.
- The day after a night shift is a day off. A day shift is never placed directly before a night shift.
- No more than **2 working days in a row**. These rest rules also continue across the border between two consecutive rosters.
- People marked as unable to work nights never get night shifts.
- Anesthesiologists and critical-care staff work only at the four middle-site stations and are the only medical staff the Regulation desk draws from.
- Every crew should have at least one Pro. If people are short, the system fills what it can and reports the gap; it never refuses to build a roster.
- Hours are balanced fairly across the whole calendar month, not only inside one roster.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
Sign-in is refused	Check the username (capital letters, spaces) and password. After 5 wrong tries, wait 15 minutes.
'Session expired - please log in again'	You were signed in for more than 12 hours. Sign in again.
'Waiting for another generation to finish'	Only one roster is built at a time. Keep the page open or come back later.
Generation seems to take very long	A full roster takes about 10 to 15 minutes. If the page was closed or the system restarted, start it again.
Station code already in use	Codes are unique. Choose a different code.
'No employees / stations / ambulances on file yet'	Add at least one of each before generating.
Roster for these dates already exists and is locked	It is submitted or published. Reopen it (submitted only), or choose different dates.
Cannot publish	Run Check conflicts and fix each line, or have a manager record an approved exception.
Anything else	Tell the administrator the screen name, what you pressed and the exact message.

Who to contact

	Name and phone (fill in)
Administrator	
Your own manager	